PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

PRD Forge Viewer

The author reads the whole PRD and its grades in one place, sees changes as they happen, and sends stakeholders a themed export marked with its version and draft status.

VERSION	0.7.1
STATUS	draft
OWNER	Richard Hightower
DOMAIN	software product management
CREATED	2026-10-26
UPDATED	2026-11-01
GOLDEN THREAD	J-001
STAKEHOLDERS	Engineering lead (PER-003); Product sponsor (PER-004); Developers (PER-002, PER-005)

Executive summary

PROBLEM	A PRD Forge set is 18 linked files. Authors cannot read it as one document or see all grades at once, and stakeholders without the authoring tools cannot read it, so feedback waits.
USERS	PRD authors and developers who use the authoring tools, and the engineering lead, sponsor, and developers who read the exported PRD.
WHY NOW	The authoring tools had their first release in October 2026, and teams adopt them only if stakeholders can review a PRD without them.
BET	The author reads the whole PRD and its grades in one place, sees changes as they happen, and sends stakeholders a themed export marked with its version and draft status.
MEASURE	Median days from sending a PRD version to the first stakeholder feedback: target 2 days or less by 2027-03-31; baseline about 10 days (owner estimate).

Contents

§	SECTION	STATUS	GRADE	BLOCKING
1	Problem and opportunity	final	83/100	—
2	Target customer and market	final	85/100	—
3	Objectives and success metrics	final	83/100	—
4	Users and personas	final	86/100	—
5	User journeys	final	90/100	—
5	Scenarios	final	81/100	—
6	Scope	final	92/100	—
7	Functional requirements	final	81/100	—
7	Wireframes	final	97/100	—
8	Non-functional requirements	final	82/100	—
9	Constraints	final	85/100	—
10	Decision rights	final	88/100	—
11	Assumptions, risks, and dependencies	review	96/100	—
12	Open questions	draft	—	—
13	Release plan	review	96/100	—
14	Glossary	draft	—	—

§	SECTION	STATUS	GRADE	BLOCKING
15	Change log	draft	—	—

About this document

PRD authors cannot read an 18-file PRD Forge set as one document or see every grade at once. Stakeholders without the authoring tools cannot read it at all, so feedback waits. The viewer shows the whole set and its grades in one place, shows changes as the authoring tools make them, searches, and makes themed export files marked with the version and draft status (formats in IN-006). Release 1 is due 2026-11-06 and delivers J-001, the golden thread. Success is feedback within 2 days of sending a version, by 2027-03-31.

SECTION	DOCUMENT
1	Problem and opportunity
2	Target customer and market
3	Objectives and success metrics
4	Users and personas
5	User journeys and Scenarios
6	Scope
7	Functional requirements
7	Wireframes
8	Non-functional requirements
9	Constraints
10	Decision rights
11	Assumptions, risks, and dependencies
12	Open questions
13	Release plan
14	Glossary
15	Change log

SECTION 1

Problem and opportunity

FINAL 83/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The authoring tools are new. They help teams write PRDs as a PRD set of 18 linked files. The authoring tools had 10 releases from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-28, and 126 people cloned them in the 14 days to 2026-10-28. Both counts come from the public release and traffic pages of the repository of the authoring tools, read on 2026-10-28. Only the PRD owner has read this PRD, as the author and as the sponsor.

ID	PROBLEM	WHO
P-001	To discuss one item, the author must first find which of 18 files holds it	PER-001, PER-002
P-002	The author packages each version by hand before a stakeholder can read it	PER-001, PER-003, PER-004, PER-005
P-003	To find the weak sections, the author opens each section and its grade note	PER-001

P-001. The author must find which file holds an item

To discuss one requirement or one scenario, the author or a developer must first find which of the 18 files holds it. The files give no picture of the whole PRD.

- **Evidence.** This set holds 25 functional requirements, 12 scenarios, and 10 non-functional requirements in 18 files, about 176 KB of text. In one review, the PRD owner searched for an item about 10 times, about 3 minutes each (owner estimate, 2026-10-28, Q-009).
- **Status quo.** The author and the developers open the files one at a time and search them for the id.
- **Why now.** 126 people cloned the authoring tools in 14 days. Each person who writes a PRD with them gets the same 18 files to search.
- **Cost of inaction.** About 30 minutes of searching in each review.
- **Desired outcome.** The author and the developers find any item without knowing which file holds it (O-001).

P-002. The author packages each version by hand

A stakeholder without the authoring tools sees raw text. Feedback waits until the author packages the PRD and sends it.

- **Evidence.** The only copy that the authoring tools make comes from a command line, holds the whole set, and has one fixed appearance. The historic PRDs took about 10 calendar days to the first stakeholder feedback. To package one version by hand takes 2 to 4 hours (owner estimate, 2026-10-28). This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool and only the PRD owner has read it. Two of the stakeholders who review a typical PRD have the authoring tools. The others read the export, or review through a stakeholder with the tools (Q-002).
- **Status quo.** The author copies the sections into one document by hand, or sends the whole set from the command line. A reader gets every section, also the ones that the reader does not need.
- **Why now.** Versions 0.4.0 and 0.5.1 of this set followed releases of the authoring tools, and each version needs a new copy.
- **Cost of inaction.** About 3 hours of the author's time to package each version, and about 10 calendar days to the first feedback, as on the historic PRDs, against a 2-day target (O-001).

- **Desired outcome.** Stakeholders read each version without the authoring tools, and give feedback within 2 days (O-001).

P-003. To find the weak sections, the author opens each section

To find the weak sections, the author must open each graded section and its grade note, 14 of each in this set. No single place shows which sections have blocking defects.

- **Evidence.** The sponsor approved version 0.3.2 while the functional requirements had 1 blocking defect (ST-008 had no must requirement). The defect stayed open until version 0.4.0. Version 0.4.0 changed 11 sections, 9 of them graded.
- **Status quo.** The author opens each section and its grade note to find the weak sections.
- **Why now.** The authoring tools changed their checks on 2026-10-27 and 2026-10-28. The sponsor approved each of versions 0.3.0 to 0.5.0 within one day of the day it was written, so the author must know the weak sections within that day.
- **Cost of inaction.** 1 blocking defect stayed open in 3 versions over 2 days, and all 3 versions (0.3.2, 0.3.3, and 0.3.4) were approved with it. The adversarial grade found it.
- **Desired outcome.** The author knows which sections are weak without opening each one, and fixes blocking defects before stakeholders see a version (O-002).

P-001

STATEMENT	To discuss one requirement or one scenario, the author or a developer must first find which of the 18 files holds it. The files give no picture of the whole PRD, so each discussion starts with a search through them.
WHO	PRD author (PER-001), and a developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
PERSONA	PER-001
EVIDENCE	

CLAIM	A PRD set has 18 files: one index and 17 section documents.
SOURCE	The document layout of the authoring tools, version 1 (C-003)

CLAIM	This PRD set holds 25 functional requirements, 12 scenarios, and 10 non-functional requirements in 18 files, about 176 KB of text.
SOURCE	Count of this PRD set by the PRD owner
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	In one review of this PRD, the PRD owner searched the files for an item about 10 times, about 3 minutes each time.
SOURCE	PRD owner estimate, answer to Q-009
AS OF	2026-10-28

STATUS QUO	The author and the developers open the files one at a time and search them for the id.
WHY NOW	126 people cloned the authoring tools in the 14 days to 2026-10-28 (public release and traffic pages of the repository of the authoring tools, read 2026-10-28). Each person who writes a PRD with them gets the same 18 files to search.
COST OF INACTION	About 30 minutes of searching in each review of a PRD: about 10 searches, about 3 minutes each (PRD owner estimate, 2026-10-28, Q-009).
DESIRED OUTCOME	The author and the developers find any item of a PRD set without knowing which file holds it (O-001).

P-002

STATEMENT
The author must package each PRD version by hand before a stakeholder without the authoring tools can read it, and the stakeholder's feedback waits for that copy.

WHO
PRD author (PER-001), and the readers of the copy (PER-003, PER-004, PER-005)

PERSONA
PER-001

EVIDENCE

CLAIM	A PRD set is plain-text files with machine-readable headers. A reader without the authoring tools sees raw text.
SOURCE	The document layout of the authoring tools, version 1 (C-003)

CLAIM	The only copy that the authoring tools make today comes from a command line inside them. It has one fixed appearance and holds the whole set.
SOURCE	The authoring tools, current release
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	The historic PRDs, written before the authoring tools, took about 10 calendar days to the first stakeholder feedback.
SOURCE	PRD owner, from the historic PRDs, confirmed 2026-10-28
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	To package one PRD version for stakeholders by hand takes the author 2 to 4 hours, about 3 hours.
SOURCE	PRD owner estimate
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	This PRD does not count for review time. It is for a new tool, and only the PRD owner has read it, as the author and as the sponsor.
SOURCE	PRD owner
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	Two of the stakeholders who review a typical PRD have the authoring tools. The others read the export, or review through a stakeholder with the tools. See Q-002.
SOURCE	PRD owner
AS OF	2026-11-01

STATUS QUO
The author copies the sections into one document by hand, or runs the command-line copy and sends the whole set. A reader then gets every section, also the ones that the reader does not need.

WHY NOW
The authoring tools had 10 releases from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-28 (public release and traffic pages of the repository of the authoring tools, read 2026-10-28). Versions 0.4.0 and 0.5.1 of this set followed two of those releases, and each new version needs a new copy for the stakeholders.

COST OF INACTION
About 3 hours of the author's time to package each PRD version (owner estimate, 2026-10-28), and about 10 calendar days to the first stakeholder feedback, as on the historic PRDs, against a target of 2 days (O-001).

DESIRED OUTCOME
Stakeholders read each PRD version without the authoring tools, and they give feedback within 2 days (O-001).

P-003

STATEMENT
To find the weak sections, the author must open each graded section and its grade note, 14 of each in this set. No single place shows which sections have blocking defects.

WHO
PRD author (PER-001)

PERSONA
PER-001

EVIDENCE

CLAIM	This set keeps a score, a count of blocking defects, and a grade date in 14 of its 17 section documents, and the findings for each of them in a separate grade note, 14 notes in all.
SOURCE	This PRD set
AS OF	2026-10-28

CLAIM	The sponsor approved version 0.3.2 while the functional requirements had 1 blocking defect (ST-008 had no must requirement). The defect stayed open in versions 0.3.2, 0.3.3, and 0.3.4, until version 0.4.0 changed the release line.
SOURCE	The change log of this PRD set (section 15), versions 0.3.2 to 0.4.0
AS OF	2026-10-27

CLAIM	Version 0.4.0 of this set changed 11 sections. 9 of them are graded sections.
SOURCE	The change log of this PRD set (section 15), version 0.4.0
AS OF	2026-10-27

STATUS QUO
The author opens each section and its grade note to find the weak sections.

WHY NOW
The authoring tools changed their checks twice in two days: release 0.8.1 on 2026-10-27 and release 0.9.0 on 2026-10-28 (change log, versions 0.4.0 and 0.5.1). The sponsor approved each of versions 0.3.0 to 0.5.0 within one day of the day it was written, so the author must know the weak sections within that day.

COST OF INACTION
1 blocking defect stayed open in 3 versions over 2 days, 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-27, and all 3 versions (0.3.2, 0.3.3, and 0.3.4) were approved with it. The adversarial grade found it.

DESIRED OUTCOME
The author knows which sections are weak without opening each section, and fixes blocking defects before stakeholders see a version (O-002).

SECTION 2

Target customer and market

FINAL 85/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The viewer is free and open source for anyone who uses the authoring tools. The PRD owner decided this on 2026-10-26. Nobody buys it. The market is the people who use the authoring tools (S-001), 126 of whom cloned them in the 14 days to 2026-10-28, and the readers of their PRDs (S-002).

ID	SEGMENT	BUYER	USER	SIZE
S-001	People who use the authoring tools	Nobody buys. The author decides to install (PER-001)	PER-001, PER-002	126 people cloned the tools in 14 days, to 2026-10-28
S-002	Stakeholders who read PRDs made with the authoring tools	No buyer. Each reader decides	PER-003, PER-004, PER-005	Not known (Q-002)

The S-001 count is of people who use the tools, not of authors only. It can be high, because one person can clone from more than one computer and automated clones count. It can also be low, because it leaves out people who got the tools earlier. Release 1 runs on macOS only (OUT-003), which limits adoption.

SUBSTITUTE	KIND	OUR EDGE
A copy that the author packages by hand	status quo	A stakeholder-ready copy in seconds (NFR-004, p95), not 2 to 4 hours (P-002)
A shared online document	direct	Each export shows its version, draft mark, and scores. No network transfer. No comments
A script that the team writes	build in house	Scores, version, and draft mark in each export, with no script to maintain
The command-line copy	indirect	A developer exports only the sections for the current work
The stepper pane	indirect	A reader without the authoring tools reads the export

Why we win, in the author's words: "Show me what is weak, then let me send it today." The viewer shows every grade in one view, and has a copy ready in seconds, not after 2 to 4 hours of packaging by hand.

Segments

S-001 · People who use the authoring tools

BUYER	Nobody buys it. The viewer is free and open source. The PRD author decides to install it.
BUYER PERSONA	PER-001
USER	PER-001, PER-002
USER PERSONAS	• PER-001 • PER-002
SIZE	126 people cloned the authoring tools in the 14 days to 2026-10-28, in 294 clones. The count is of people who use the tools, authors and developers, not of authors only. The count can be high, because one person can clone from more than one computer and automated clones count. It can also be low, because it leaves out people who got the tools before that period. The number of teams is not known (R-002).
SIZE SOURCE	GitHub traffic page of the authoring tools, https://github.com/SpillwaveSolutions/prd-forge, read by the PRD owner
SIZE AS OF	2026-10-28
SIZE METHOD	bottom-up
SIZE UNIT	people
WILLINGNESS TO PAY	None needed. The viewer is free.
ADOPTION BARRIERS	• Release 1 runs on macOS only (OUT-003). • The author must install one more app beside the authoring tools.

S-002 · Stakeholders who read PRDs made with the authoring tools

BUYER	No buyer. Nobody buys it, and no one decides for the readers. Each reader decides to install the free viewer, or reads only the copy that the author sends.
USER	PER-003, PER-004, PER-005
USER PERSONAS	• PER-003 • PER-004 • PER-005
SIZE	Not known. Q-002 asks the PRD owner to count the reviewers of each PRD, and how many of them have the authoring tools, by 2026-11-30.
SIZE AS OF	2026-10-28
SIZE UNIT	people
WILLINGNESS TO PAY	None needed. The viewer is free.
ADOPTION BARRIERS	• A reader who has the copy can read the PRD without the viewer (IN-006).

Competitors

The status quo, a copy that the author packages by hand

KIND	status-quo
OFFER	The author copies the sections into one document by hand and sends the file. It takes 2 to 4 hours for each version (P-002).
OUR EDGE	The author has a stakeholder-ready copy of a new version in seconds, 10 seconds at p95 for a set of up to 18 documents (NFR-004), not after 2 to 4 hours of packaging by hand (P-002).

A shared online document that the author pastes the PRD into

KIND	direct
OFFER	Stakeholders read and comment on one document in a web browser.
OUR EDGE	Each export shows the version and the draft mark (FR-014) and the score of every section (FR-019), so the sponsor and the engineering lead can check which graded version they read. The viewer makes no network transfer (NFR-005). The viewer does not offer comments, and the shared document does.

A script that the team writes to join the files

KIND	build-in-house
OFFER	The team writes and maintains its own script that joins the 18 files into one document.
OUR EDGE	The engineering lead sees the status and score of every section (FR-019), and the sponsor sees the version and the draft mark (FR-014). The team has no script to write or maintain.

The command-line copy of the authoring tools

KIND	indirect
OFFER	One PDF and one Word file of the whole set, in one fixed appearance.
OUR EDGE	A developer sends a file with only the sections for the current work (FR-012), and the team reads it without the authoring tools, not all 18 documents.

The stepper pane of the authoring tools

KIND	indirect
OFFER	Steps through the sections one at a time, inside the authoring tools.
OUR EDGE	The author exports the set (FR-010), and a reader without the authoring tools reads it. The stepper pane works only inside the authoring tools.

SECTION 3

Objectives and success metrics

FINAL 83/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

ID	OBJECTIVE	METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET	BY	OWNER
O-001	Stakeholders give feedback sooner	Median days from send to first written feedback	About 10 days (owner estimate)	2 days or less	2027-03-31	Richard Hightower
O-002	Blocking defects fixed before sending	Blocking defects in a version on the day it is sent	1 (this PRD, 0.2.0)	0	2027-03-31	Richard Hightower

O-001. Stakeholders give feedback on a PRD version sooner

Metric: median calendar days from the day the author sends a PRD version to a stakeholder, to the day of the first written feedback from any stakeholder on that version. Serves P-001 and P-002.

Baseline: about 10 calendar days, from the historic PRDs written before the authoring tools (PRD owner, 2026-10-26, confirmed 2026-10-28). This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool (Q-001).

Target: 2 days or less by 2027-03-31. Owner: Richard Hightower, PRD owner.

O-002. Authors fix blocking defects before stakeholders see a version

Metric: the count of blocking defects in a PRD version on the day the author sends it. Serves P-003. Baseline: 1, in version 0.2.0 of this PRD. Target: 0 in every version sent, by 2027-03-31.

Objectives

> **O-001 · Stakeholders give feedback on a PRD version sooner.**
>
> PROBLEMS
> - P-001
> - P-002
>
> METRIC: Median calendar days from the day the author sends a PRD version to a stakeholder, to the day of the first written feedback from any stakeholder on that version.
>
> BASELINE: About 10 calendar days, from the historic PRDs written before the authoring tools (PRD owner, 2026-10-26, confirmed 2026-10-28). This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool (Q-001).
>
> BASELINE QUESTION: Q-001
>
> TARGET: 2 days or less
>
> BY: 2027-03-31
>
> OWNER: Richard Hightower, PRD owner

O-002 · Authors fix blocking defects before stakeholders see a version.

PROBLEMS	• P-003
METRIC	Count of blocking defects in a PRD version on the day the author sends it to a stakeholder, read from the grades in the export.
BASELINE	1 blocking defect in version 0.2.0 of this PRD, sent on or after 2026-10-26.
TARGET	0 blocking defects in every version sent
BY	2027-03-31
OWNER	Richard Hightower, PRD owner

SECTION 4

Users and personas

FINAL 86/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

PER-001 is the primary persona. Release 1 is designed around the PRD author. The personas work in a consulting engagement: the author's firm writes the PRD, and the client's executive approves it. PER-003, PER-004, and PER-005 usually read the exported PRD. They can also use the viewer, so it must be usable without training.

ID	PERSONA	USES THE AUTHORING TOOLS	READS THE PRD IN	AUTHORITY
PER-001	PRD author, senior consultant or product lead	Yes	The viewer	Owns the PRD
PER-002	Developer with the authoring tools	Yes	The viewer	Chooses own items and exports
PER-003	Engineering lead, client or delivery team	Usually no	The export	Reviews
PER-004	Product sponsor, client executive	No	The export	Approves
PER-005	Developer without the authoring tools	No	The export	None

PER-001. PRD author

"Show me what is weak, then let me send it today." Goals: see the whole PRD and go to one section, see which sections are weak, and send the PRD to stakeholders quickly. Pains: P-001, P-002, P-003. Authority: owns the PRD and cannot approve it.

PER-002. Developer who uses the authoring tools

Goals: find the requirements, stories, and scenarios for the current work, and export a part of the PRD. Pain: P-001. Authority: chooses own items and exports; cannot approve the PRD.

PER-003. Engineering lead

Goals: decide if the team can build from the PRD, and send back what is missing. Pain: P-002. Authority: reviews, does not approve.

PER-004. Product sponsor

"Two pages, then I decide." Goal: read a short summary and approve or reject the PRD. Journey: J-003. Pain: P-002. Authority: the only persona who approves.

PER-005. Developer who does not use the authoring tools

Goal: read the sections for the current work. Pain: P-002. Authority: none.

PER-001

NAME	PRD author, a senior consultant or product lead at a consulting firm, who uses the authoring tools
SHORT NAME	Author
PRIMARY	yes
PROBLEMS	• P-001 • P-002 • P-003
GOALS	• Show me what is weak, then let me send it today. • See the whole PRD and go directly to the section under discussion • See which sections are weak and what to fix before anyone else reads them • Send the PRD to stakeholders quickly, in a form they can read without the tools
PAINS	• The PRD is 18 files, and finding one section or one item takes a search (P-001) • Stakeholders cannot read the files without the tools (P-002) • Grades and gaps are spread across 17 files (P-003)
FREQUENCY	Opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD (Q-003). Exports once for each version sent to stakeholders, including draft versions.
AUTHORITY	Owns the PRD. Chooses which PRD set to open. Decides its content, which sections to fix, and the status of each section, which decides the draft mark. Chooses the format, theme, and sections of an export, and which version to send to whom. Cannot approve it.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in the business domain. Uses the authoring tools. Often not an experienced product manager.

PER-002

NAME	Developer on the consulting delivery team who uses the authoring tools but did not write the PRD
SHORT NAME	ToolsDeveloper
PROBLEMS	• P-001
GOALS	• Give me the requirements for my story, nothing else. • Find the requirements, stories, and scenarios for the current work without reading the whole PRD • Export a part of the PRD to share with the team
PAINS	• Finding one requirement or scenario across 18 files takes a search (P-001)
FREQUENCY	Not known (Q-003).
AUTHORITY	Chooses which PRD set to open. Decides which items apply to own work, and the format, theme, and sections of an export to share. Cannot approve the PRD.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software and in the authoring tools. May not know the business domain.

PER-003 · Engineering lead on the client or delivery team that builds the product

SHORT NAME	EngineeringLead
PROBLEMS	• P-002
GOALS	• Can my team build this, yes or no? • Decide if the team can build the product from this PRD • Find what is missing or unclear, and send it back to the author
PAINS	• Does not use the authoring tools, so cannot read the set without an export (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	Reviews and comments. Decides if the team can build from the PRD. Does not approve it.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software. Usually does not use the authoring tools.

PER-004 · Product sponsor, a client executive who approves the PRD

SHORT NAME	Sponsor
PROBLEMS	• P-002
GOALS	• Two pages, then I decide. • Read a short summary and decide to approve or reject the PRD
PAINS	• Cannot read the set without the authoring tools, and will not read 18 files (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	Approves or rejects the PRD. The only persona who approves.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in the business. Does not use the authoring tools. Reads a few pages only.

PER-005 · Developer on the client or delivery team who does not use the authoring tools

SHORT NAME	TeamDeveloper
PROBLEMS	• P-002
GOALS	• Send me the part I need. • Read the sections that apply to the current work
PAINS	• Cannot read the set without an export (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	None for the PRD.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software. Does not use the authoring tools.

SECTION 5

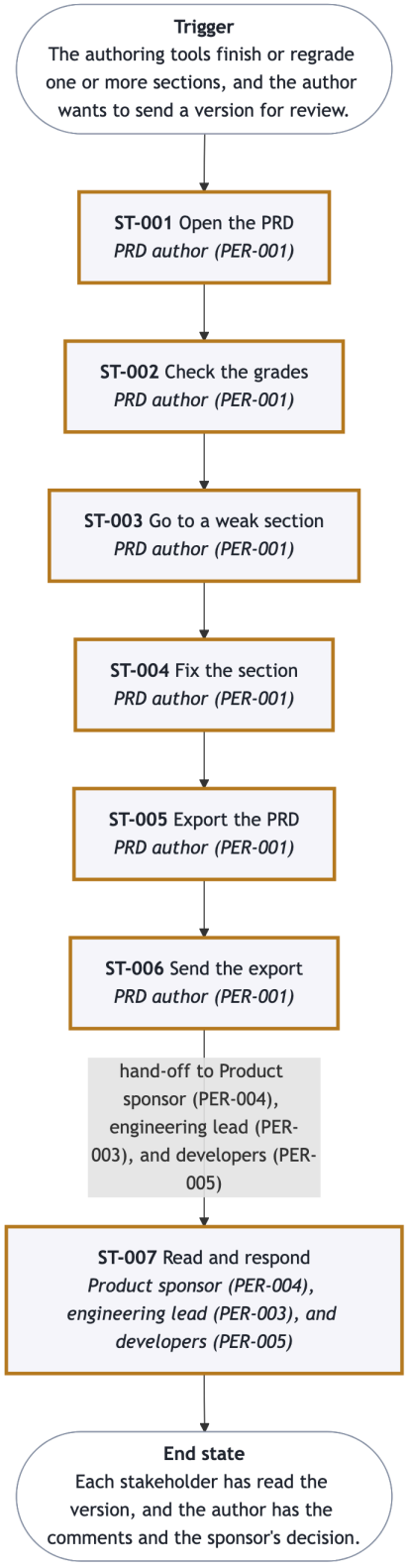
User journeys

FINAL 90/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

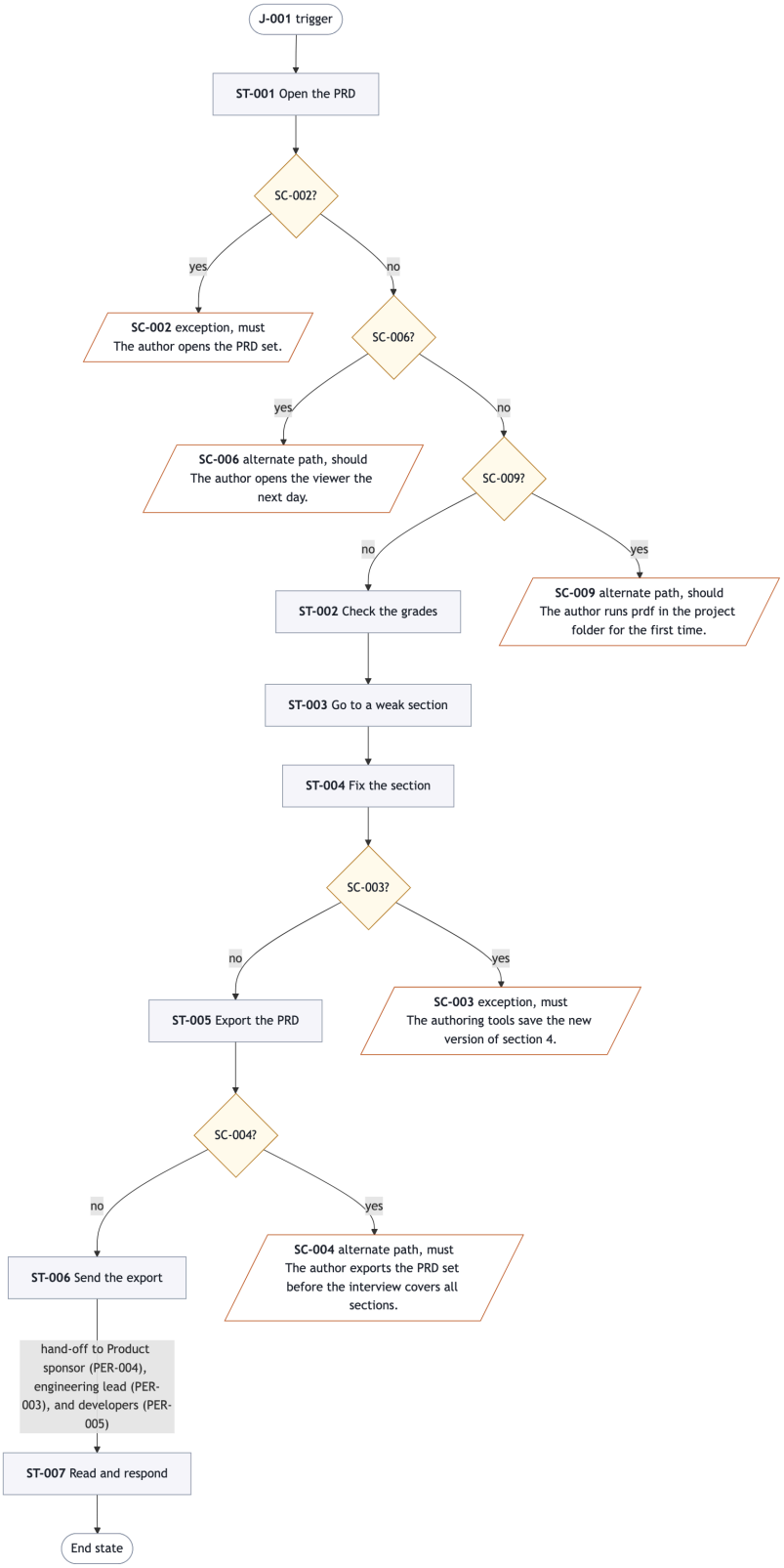
J-001 is the golden thread: the one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end.

ID	PERSONA	GOAL	STAGES	GOLDEN THREAD
J-001	PER-001 PRD author	Stakeholders read the PRD and the author has their feedback	ST-001 to ST-007	Yes
J-003	PER-004 Product sponsor	The sponsor approves or rejects a version	ST-011 to ST-012	No
J-002	PER-002 Developer with the authoring tools	The developer has the items for the current work and shares them	ST-008 to ST-010	No

J-001. The author sends a reviewed PRD to stakeholders



J-001 journey diagram



J-001 overview with its main alternate and exception paths

Trigger: the authoring tools finish or regrade sections, and the author wants to send a version for review.

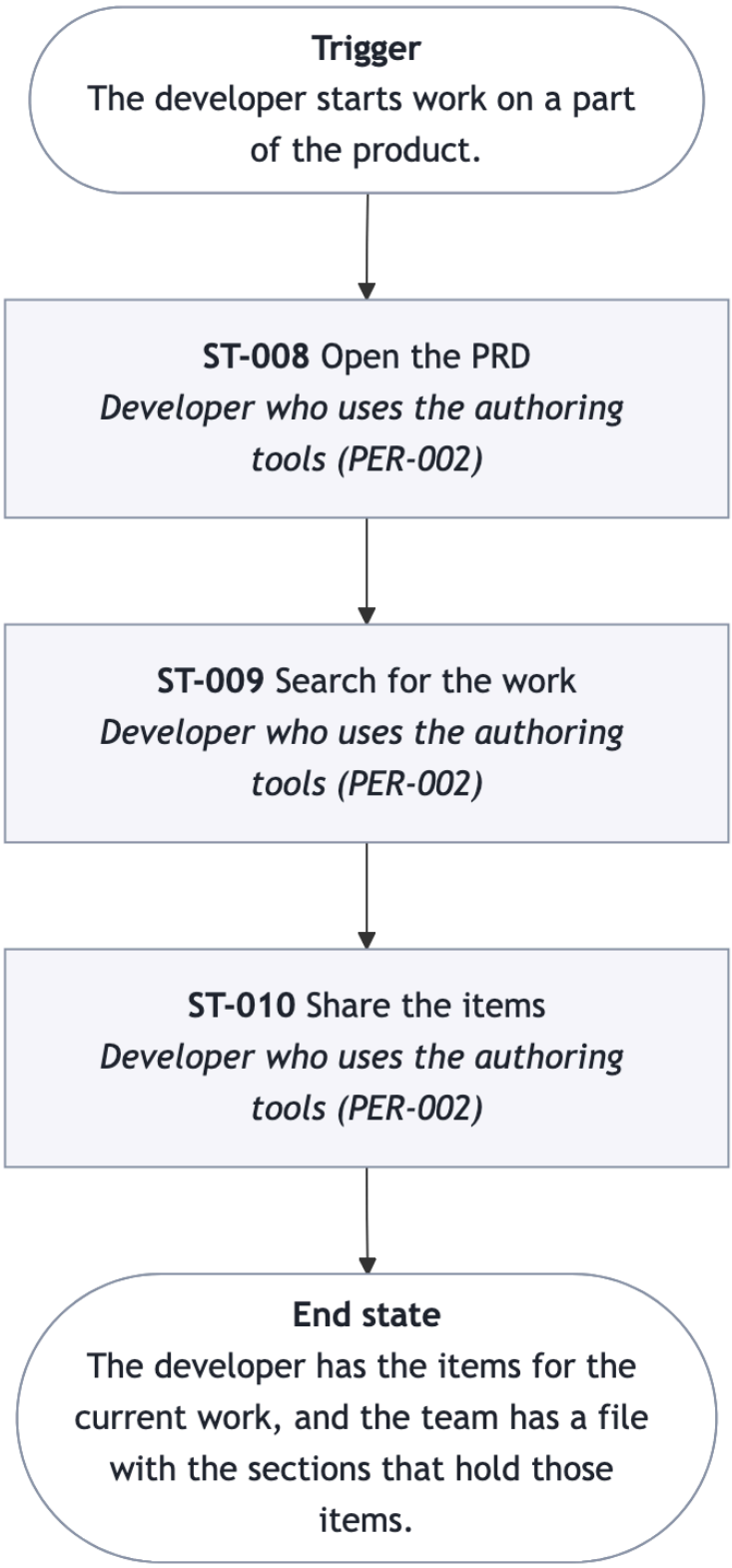
STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-001. Open the PRD	PRD author	Is this the correct PRD and version?
ST-002. Check the grades	PRD author	Which sections must be fixed first?

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-003. Go to a weak section	PRD author	Fix it now, or send it as a draft?
ST-004. Fix the section	PRD author, in the authoring tools	Is the section good enough to send?
ST-005. Export the PRD	PRD author	Which format, theme, and sections?
ST-006. Send the export	PRD author	Who receives this version?
ST-007. Read and respond	Sponsor, engineering lead, developers	Approve or reject, and comment

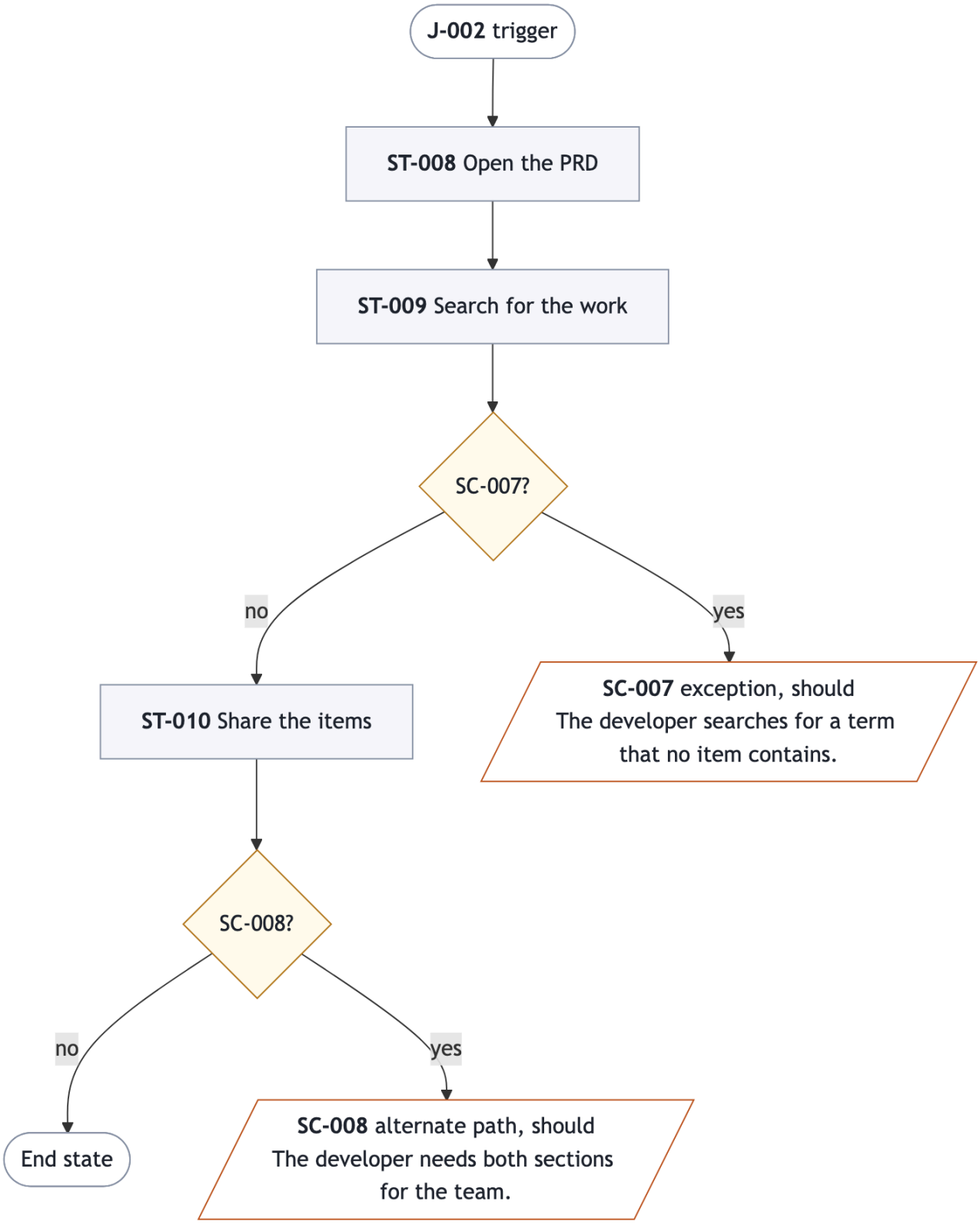
The author fixes sections in the authoring tools, not in the viewer. The viewer shows the change without any action from the author. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer.

End state: each stakeholder has read the version, and the author has the comments and the sponsor's decision.

J-002. A developer finds and shares the items for the current work



J-002 journey diagram



J-002 overview with its main alternate and exception paths

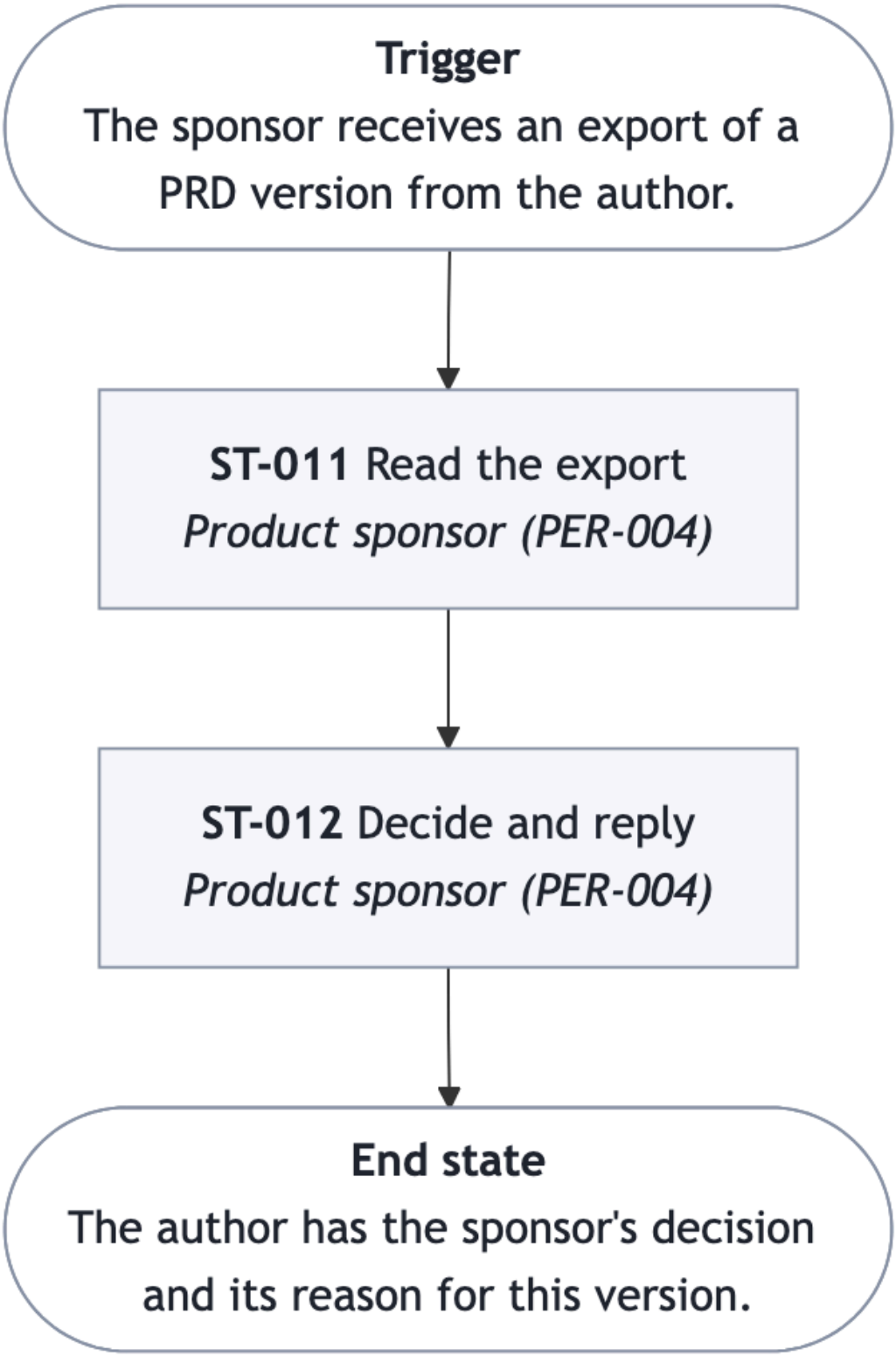
Trigger: the developer starts work on a part of the product.

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-008. Open the PRD	Developer with the authoring tools	Is this the correct PRD and version?
ST-009. Search for the work	Developer with the authoring tools	Which items apply to the current work?

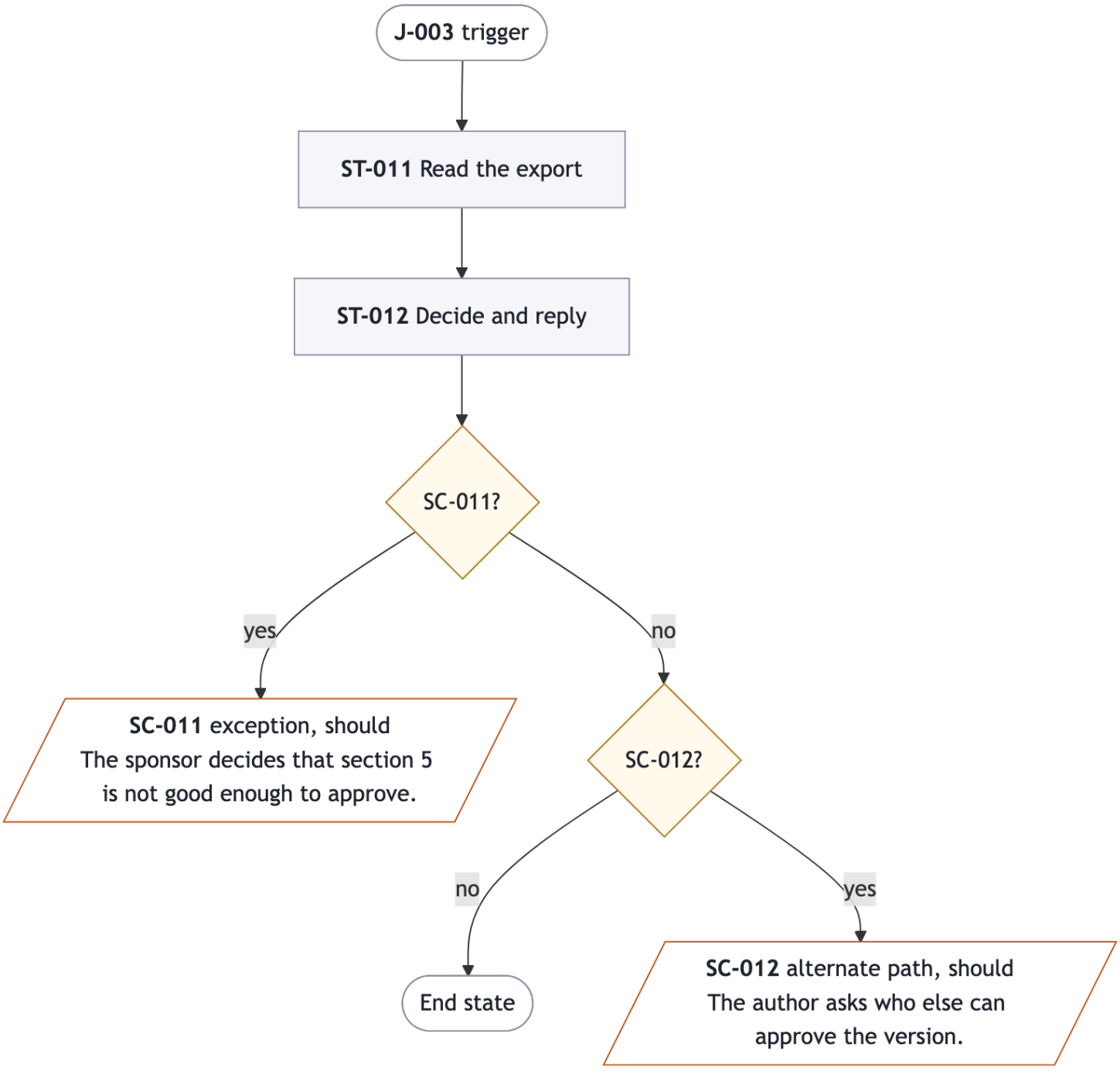
STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-010. Share the items	Developer with the authoring tools	Which sections does the team need?

End state: the developer has the items for the current work, and the team has a file with those items.

J-003. The sponsor approves or rejects a version



J-003 journey diagram



J-003 overview with its main alternate and exception paths

Trigger: the sponsor receives an export of a PRD version.

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-011. Read the export	Product sponsor	Is there enough here to decide?
ST-012. Decide and reply	Product sponsor	Approve or reject this version

End state: the author has the sponsor's decision and its reason. Both stages happen outside the viewer. The export must carry what the sponsor needs (FR-014, FR-019).

J-001

GOAL	Stakeholders have a version of the PRD they can read without the tools, and the author has their feedback.
PERSONA	PER-001
TRIGGER	The authoring tools finish or regrade one or more sections, and the author wants to send a version for review.
GOLDEN THREAD	yes

STAGES

Open the PRD

ID	ST-001
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author opens the PRD set. • The author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and the status of every section.
INPUTS	• The PRD set
OUTPUTS	• The whole PRD, with the status of every section
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, and the status of every document in order.
DECISION	Is this the correct PRD and version?

Check the grades

ID	ST-002
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author sees the score, the count of blocking defects, and the grade date for each section. • The author sees which sections are pending, draft, review, or final.
INPUTS	• The grades that the authoring tools recorded
OUTPUTS	• A list of the sections that are weak or not started
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a set with graded and ungraded sections, when the author checks the grades, then the author sees the score, blocking count, and grade date of each graded section, and which sections are not graded.
DECISION	Which sections must be fixed before anyone else reads the PRD?

Go to a weak section

ID	ST-003
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author goes directly to a section, or searches for an item such as a requirement or a scenario. • The author reads the section and sees its status, score, and count of blocking defects.
INPUTS	• A section name, or a search term and a category
OUTPUTS	• The section or the item, with its status and grade
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a weak section, when the author selects it or searches for one of its items, then the author reads it with its status, score, and blocking count.
DECISION	Fix the section now, or send the PRD as a draft?

Fix the section

ID	ST-004
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)

STEPS	• The author fixes the section in the authoring tools, outside the viewer. • The author sees the changed section and its new grade in the viewer, without any action in the viewer.
INPUTS	• The author's answers to the wizard
OUTPUTS	• The changed section, with its new grade
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author reads a section in the viewer, when the authoring tools save a new version of it, then the author sees the new text and grade without any action.
DECISION	Is the section good enough to send?

Export the PRD

ID	ST-005
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author selects a document format that the readers open without the authoring tools. • The author selects an export theme. • The author selects the whole PRD or some sections. • The author saves or prints the export.
INPUTS	• The format, the theme, and the sections
OUTPUTS	• One file that a reader can open without the tools, or a printed copy
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author selects a format, a theme, and some sections, when the author exports, then the author has one file with only those sections, in that theme, that a reader opens without the authoring tools.
DECISION	Which format, theme, and sections do these readers need?

Send the export

ID	ST-006
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author sends the file to the stakeholders, outside the viewer.
INPUTS	• The exported file
OUTPUTS	• The stakeholders have the file
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an exported file, when the author sends it, then each chosen stakeholder has the file.
DECISION	Who receives this version?
HANDOFF	Product sponsor (PER-004), engineering lead (PER-003), and developers (PER-005)

Read and respond

ID	ST-007
ACTOR	Product sponsor (PER-004), engineering lead (PER-003), and developers (PER-005)

STEPS	• Each reader opens the file and sees the version, and sees if it is a draft. • The engineering lead and the developers reply with comments. • The sponsor approves or rejects the version.
INPUTS	• The exported file
OUTPUTS	• Comments, and the sponsor's approval or rejection
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a stakeholder has the file, when the stakeholder opens it, then the stakeholder sees the version and if it is a draft, and can reply with comments or a decision.
DECISION	The sponsor approves or rejects. The engineering lead decides if the team can build from it.
HANDOFF	PRD author (PER-001), who receives the feedback

PAIN POINTS

- The PRD is 18 files, so finding one section or item takes a search (P-001).
- The grades and gaps are in 17 separate files (P-003).
- Readers without the tools cannot read the files (P-002).
- While the authoring tools change a section, the author cannot be sure that the view is current.
- A reader of a draft cannot tell that it is a draft.

NEEDS

- One view of the whole PRD, with direct access to each section and a search for items.
- One view of the grades, blocking defects, and gaps of all sections.
- An export in a format that a reader opens without the tools, in a theme the author selects.
- The view shows each change to a section without any action from the author.
- The export shows the version and the status of the PRD and of each section.

END STATE

Each stakeholder has read the version, and the author has the comments and the sponsor's decision.

J-002

GOAL

The developer has the sections and items for the current work, such as requirements, journeys, and scenarios, and can share those sections with the team.

PERSONA

PER-002

TRIGGER

The developer starts work on a part of the product.

STAGES

Open the PRD

ID	ST-008
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer opens the PRD set and sees the list of sections.
INPUTS	• The PRD set
OUTPUTS	• The whole PRD
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set, when the developer opens it, then the developer sees the version and the list of sections.
DECISION	Is this the correct PRD and version?

Search for the work

ID	ST-009
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer enters a search term and selects a category, such as requirements, journeys, or scenarios, or all. • The developer sees the best matches first, each with its section and id. • The developer opens a match and follows its links to related items.
INPUTS	• A search term and a category
OUTPUTS	• The matching items, best match first
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a search term and a category, when the developer searches, then the developer sees the matching items best first, each with its id and section, and opens one in one action.
DECISION	Which items apply to the current work?

Share the items

ID	ST-010
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer exports the selected sections in a document format the team opens without the authoring tools, or prints them. • The developer sends the file to the team, outside the viewer.
INPUTS	• The selected sections, the format, and the theme
OUTPUTS	• One file with only those sections
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the developer selects two sections, when the developer exports them, then the team has one file with only those two sections.
DECISION	Which sections does the team need?
HANDOFF	Developers on the team (PER-005)

PAIN POINTS

- Finding one requirement or scenario in 18 files takes a search (P-001).
- The team needs only the sections for the current work, not the whole PRD.

NEEDS

- A search by term and category, with the best matches first.
- An export of selected sections only.

END STATE — The developer has the items for the current work, and the team has a file with the sections that hold those items.

J-003 · The sponsor approves or rejects a version of the PRD, with a reason.

PERSONA — PER-004

TRIGGER — The sponsor receives an export of a PRD version from the author.

STAGES

Read the export

ID — ST-011

ACTOR — Product sponsor (PER-004)

STEPS
- The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools.
- The sponsor sees the version and if it is a draft on the first page.
- The sponsor reads the executive summary and the contents list with the status and score of each section.

INPUTS
- The exported file

OUTPUTS
- The sponsor knows what the PRD proposes and how complete it is

ACCEPTANCE
- Given an export of a draft version, when the sponsor opens it, then the first page shows the version and the word Draft, then the summary and the status and score of every section.

DECISION — Is there enough here to decide, or must the author answer questions first?

Decide and reply

ID — ST-012

ACTOR — Product sponsor (PER-004)

STEPS
- The sponsor approves or rejects the version, outside the viewer.
- The sponsor sends the decision and the reason to the author.

INPUTS
- The sponsor's reading of the export

OUTPUTS
- An approval or a rejection, with a reason

ACCEPTANCE
- Given the sponsor decided on a version, when the sponsor replies, then the author has the decision and its reason.

DECISION — Approve or reject this version.

HANDOFF — PRD author (PER-001), who records the decision in the change log

PAIN POINTS
- The sponsor will not read 18 files to make a decision (P-002).

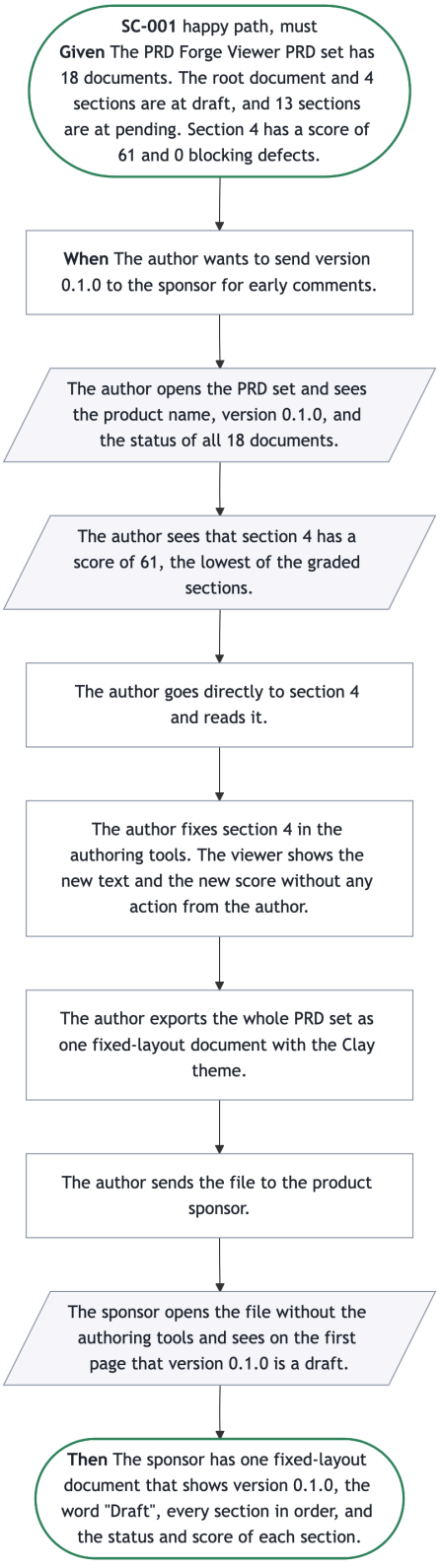
NEEDS
- One short file that starts with the version, the draft mark, the summary, and the status of every section.

END STATE — The author has the sponsor's decision and its reason for this version.

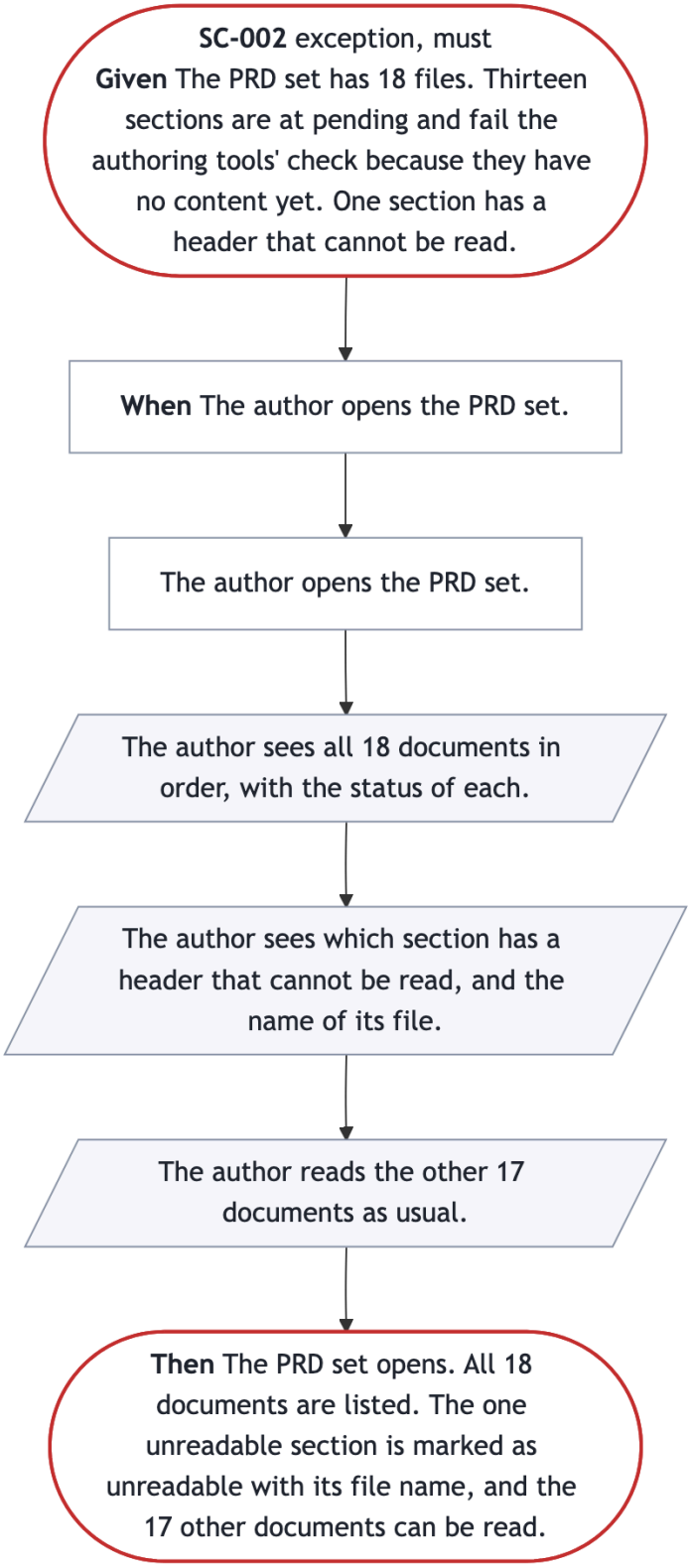
SECTION 5

Scenarios

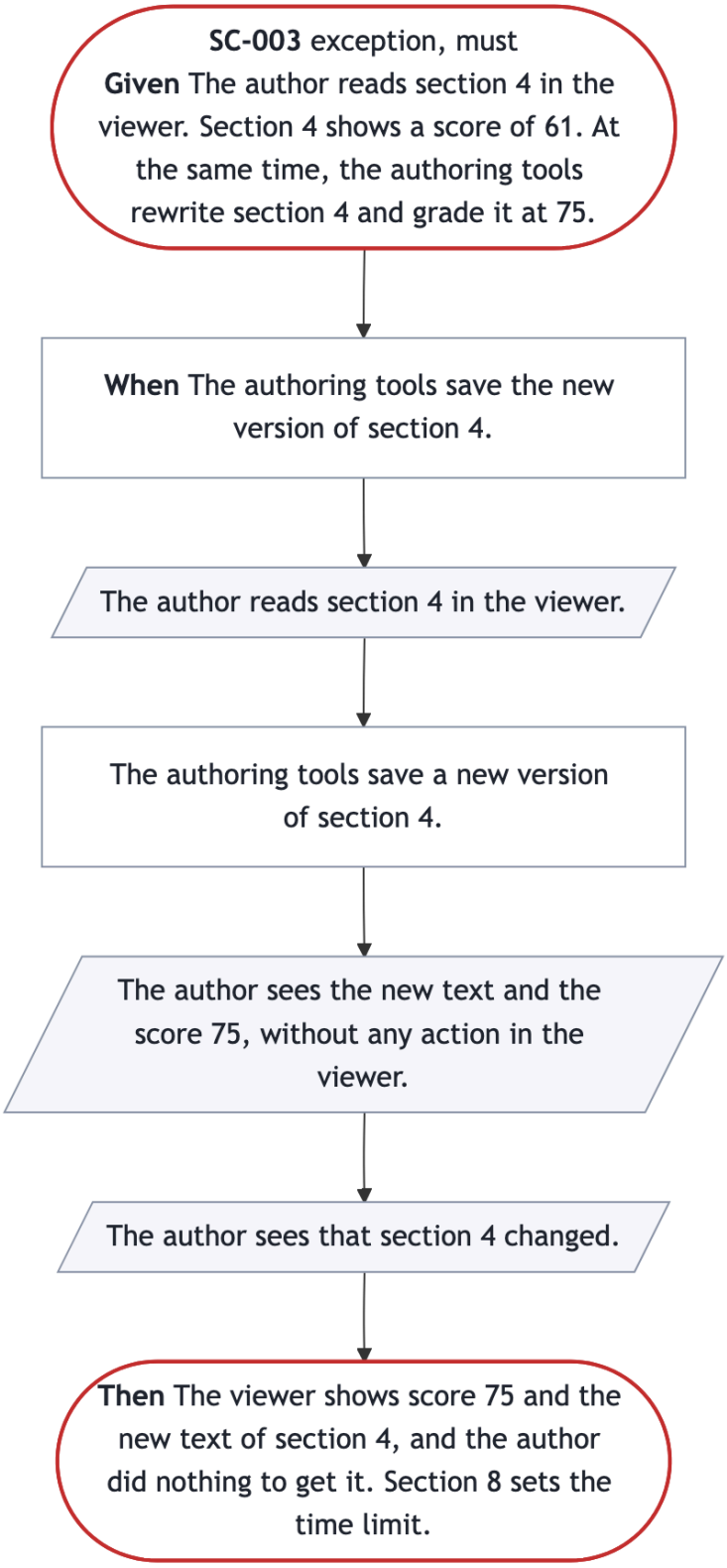
FINAL 81/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



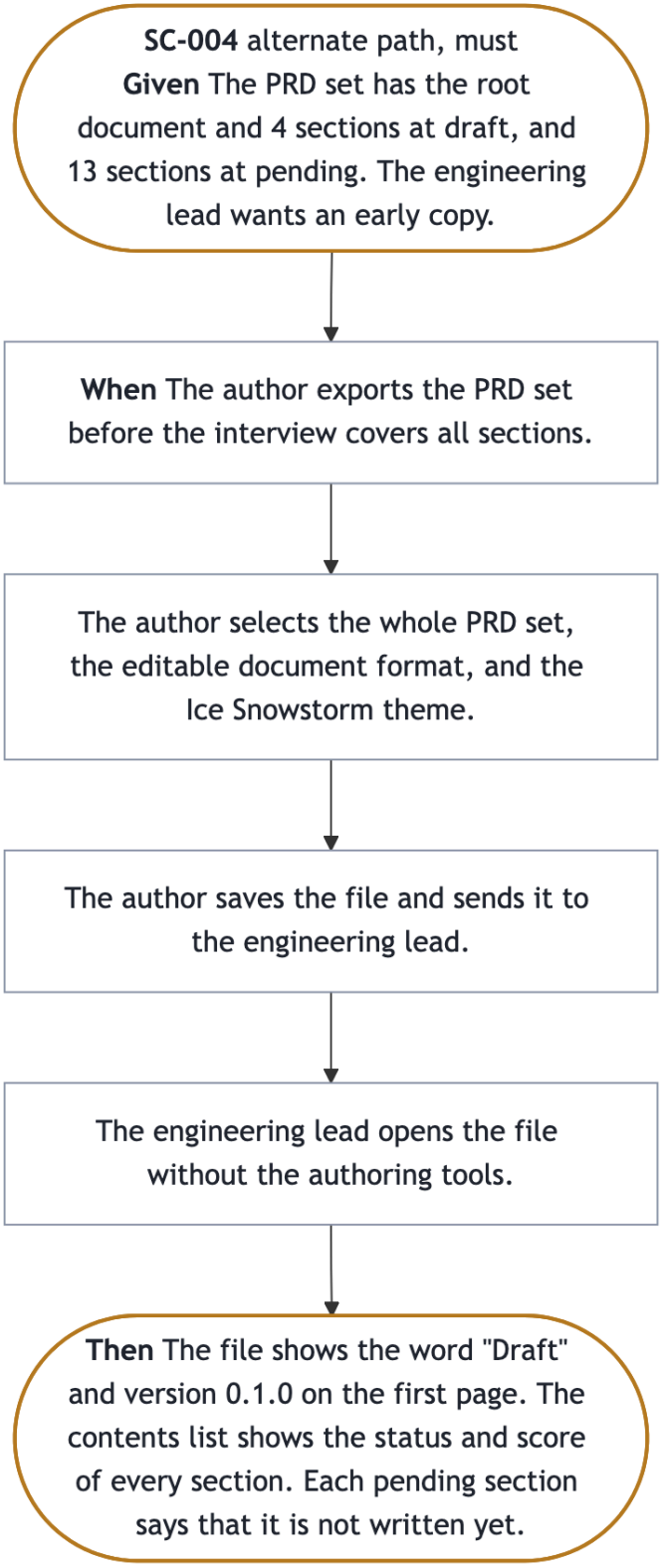
SC-001 scenario



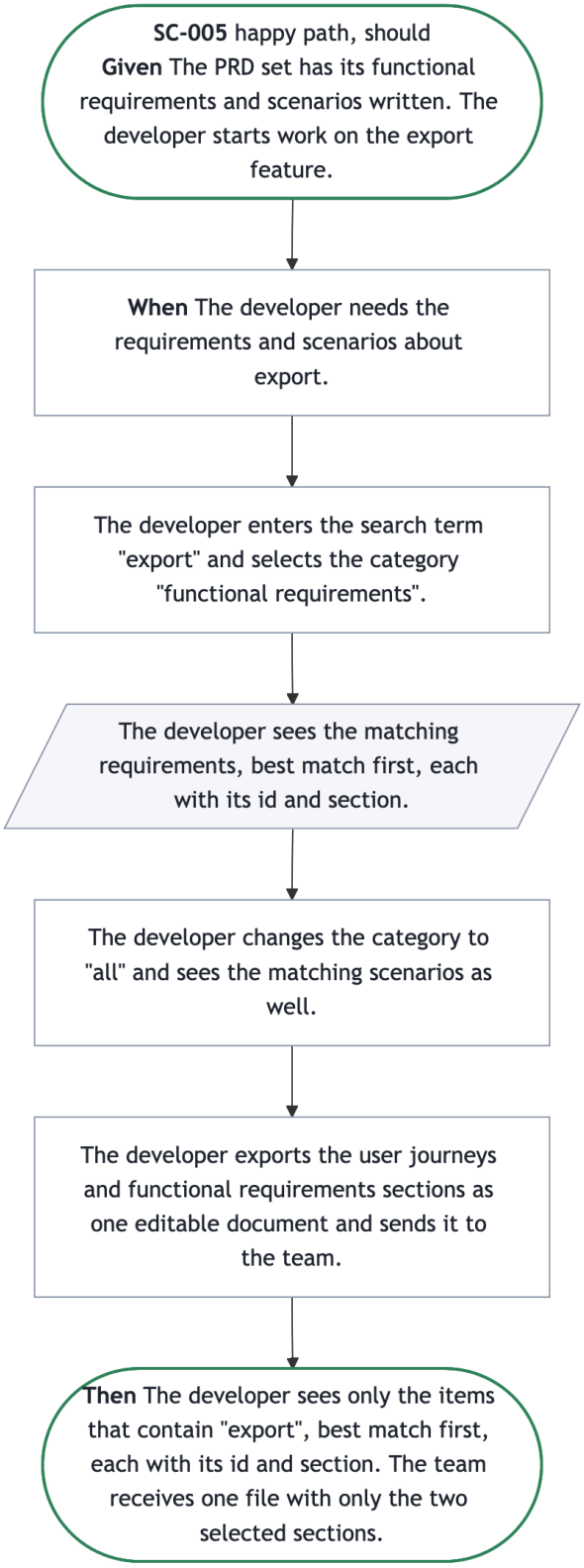
SC-002 scenario



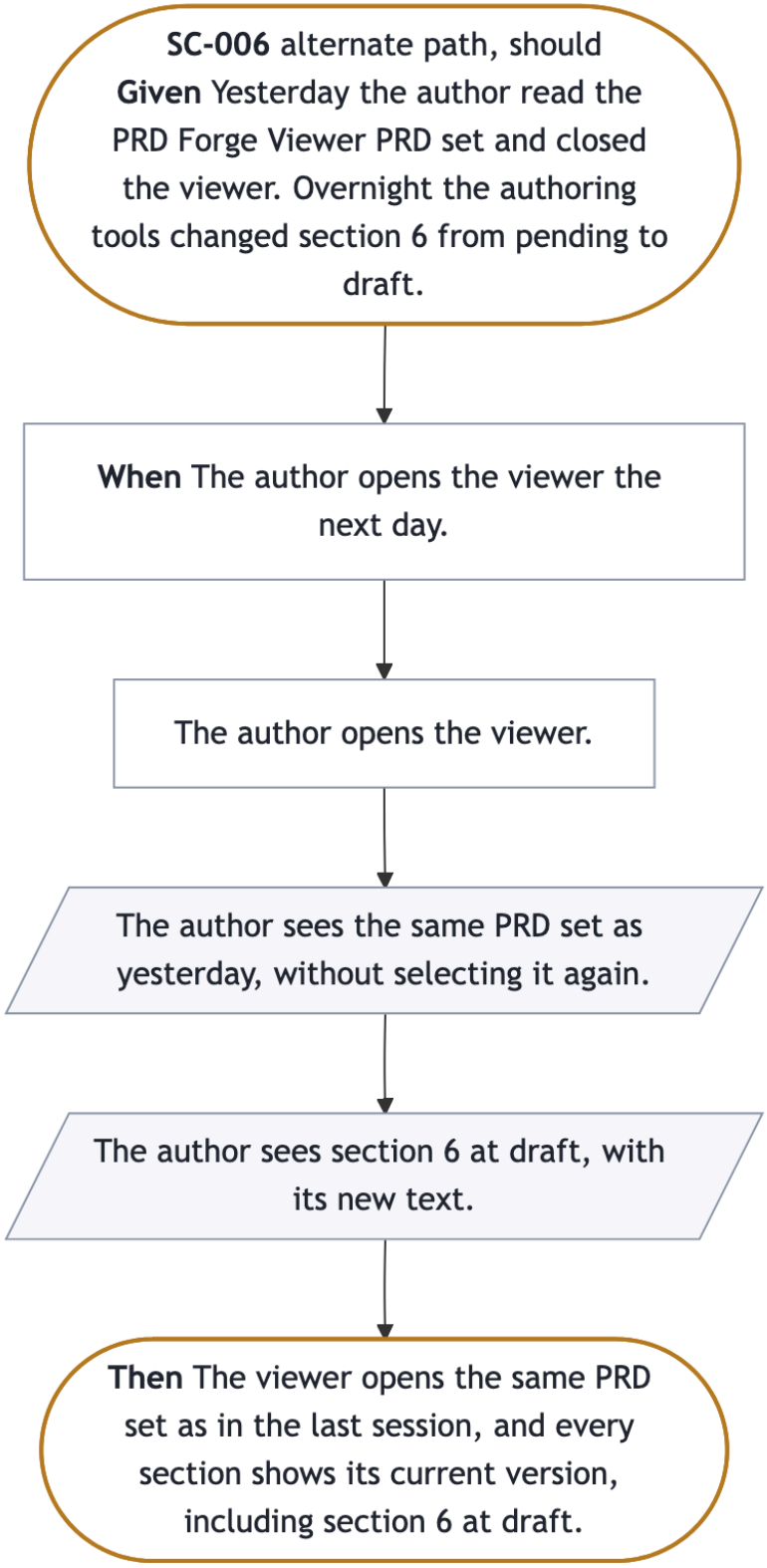
SC-003 scenario



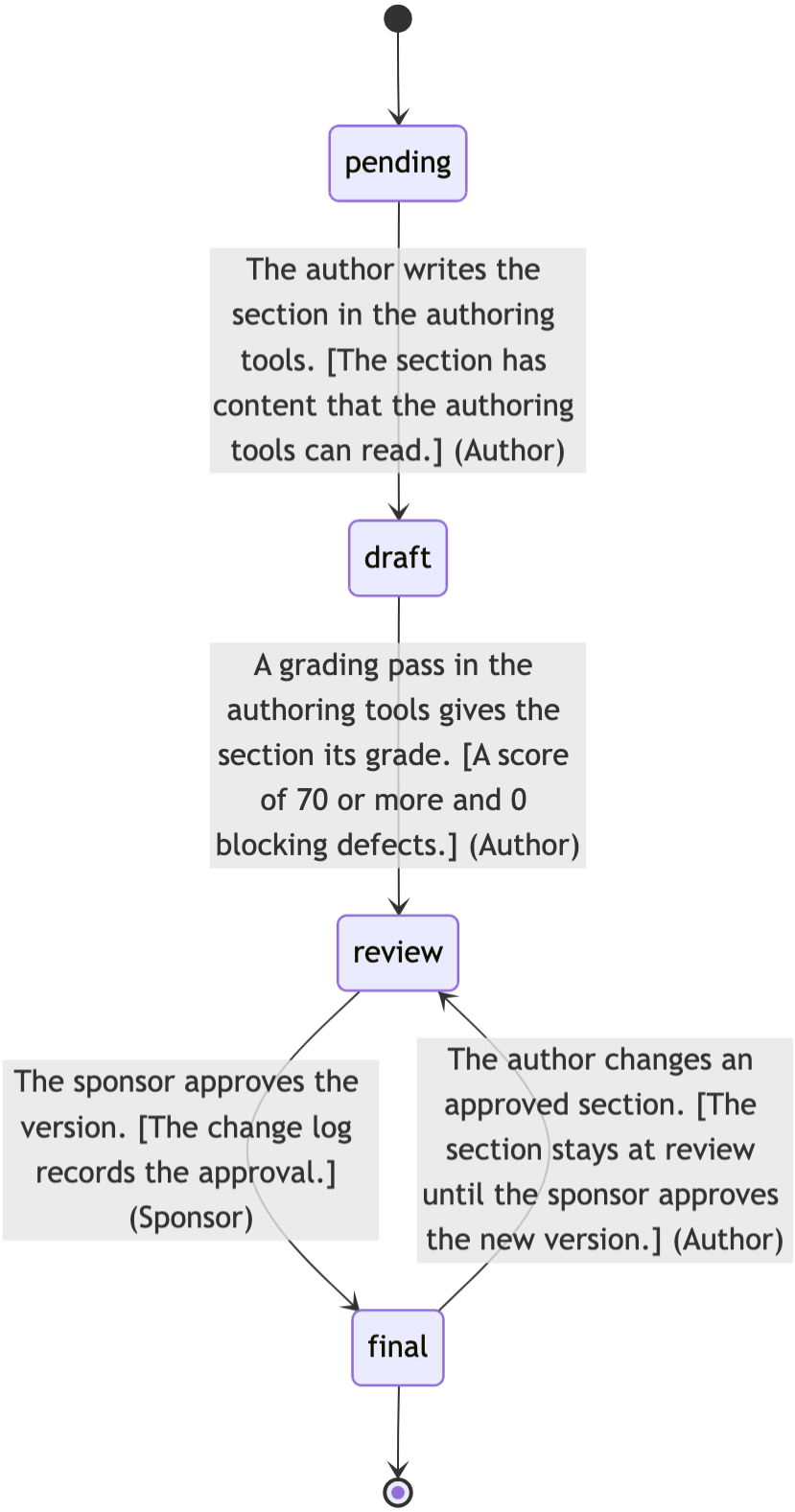
SC-004 scenario



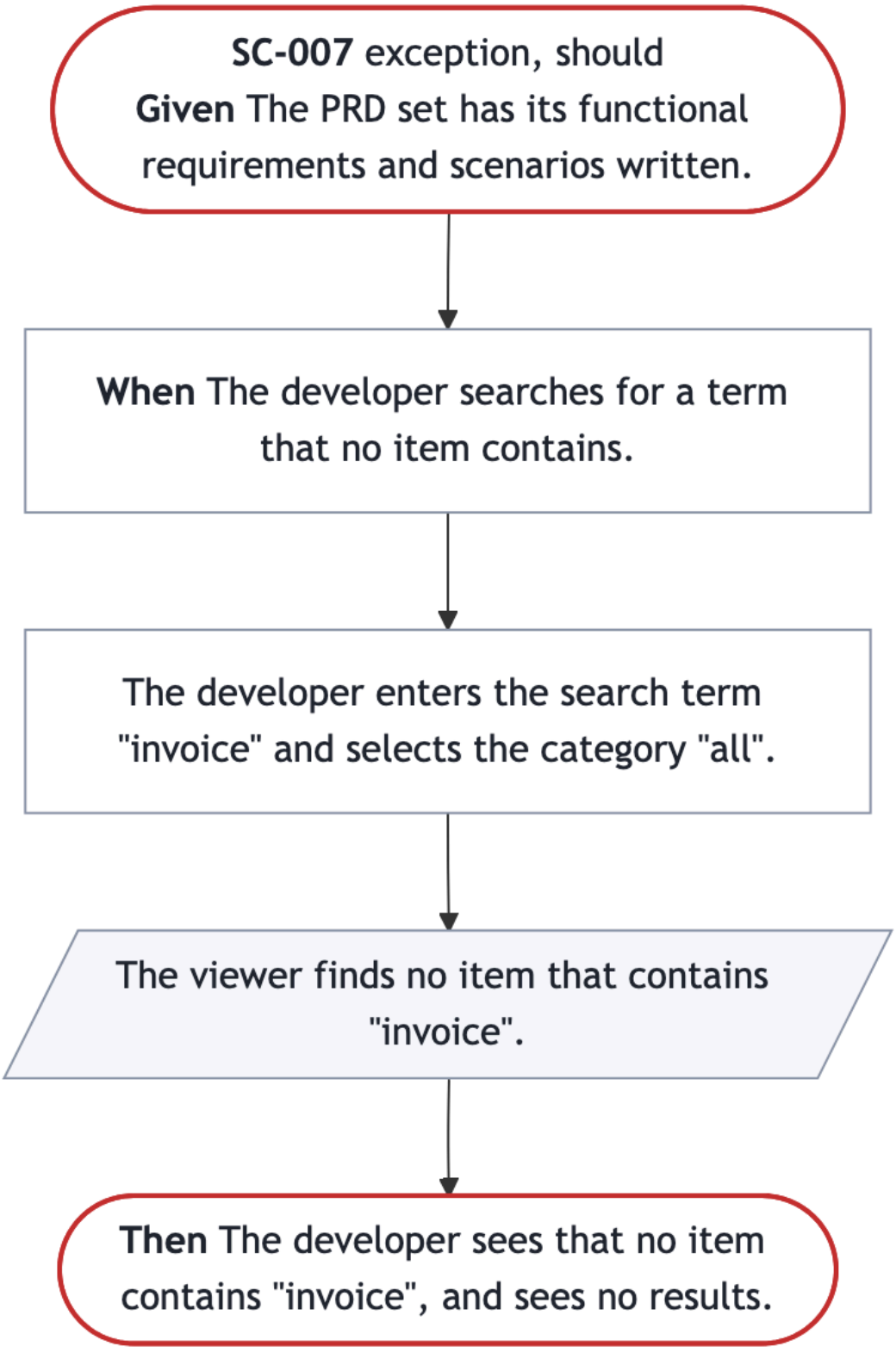
SC-005 scenario



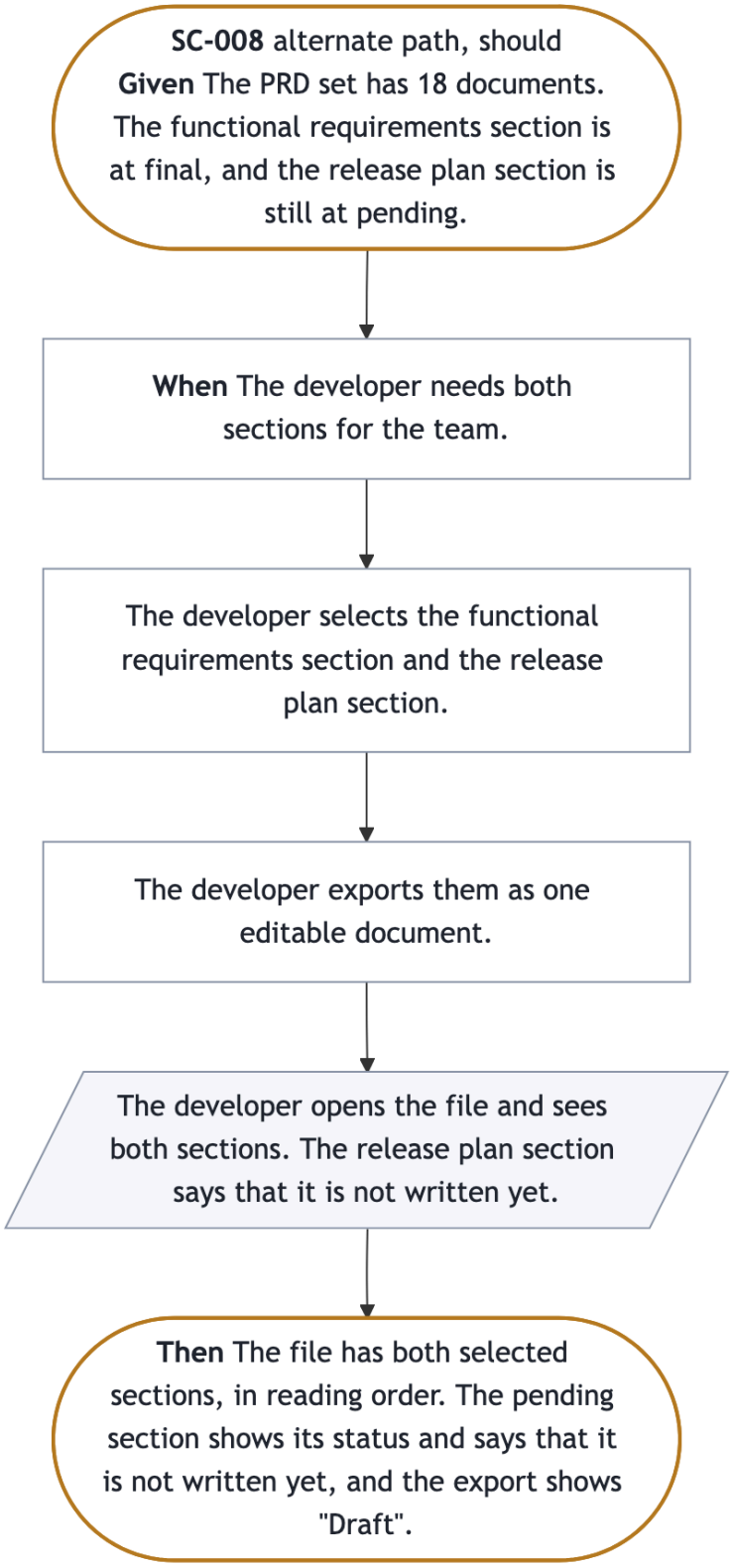
SC-006 scenario



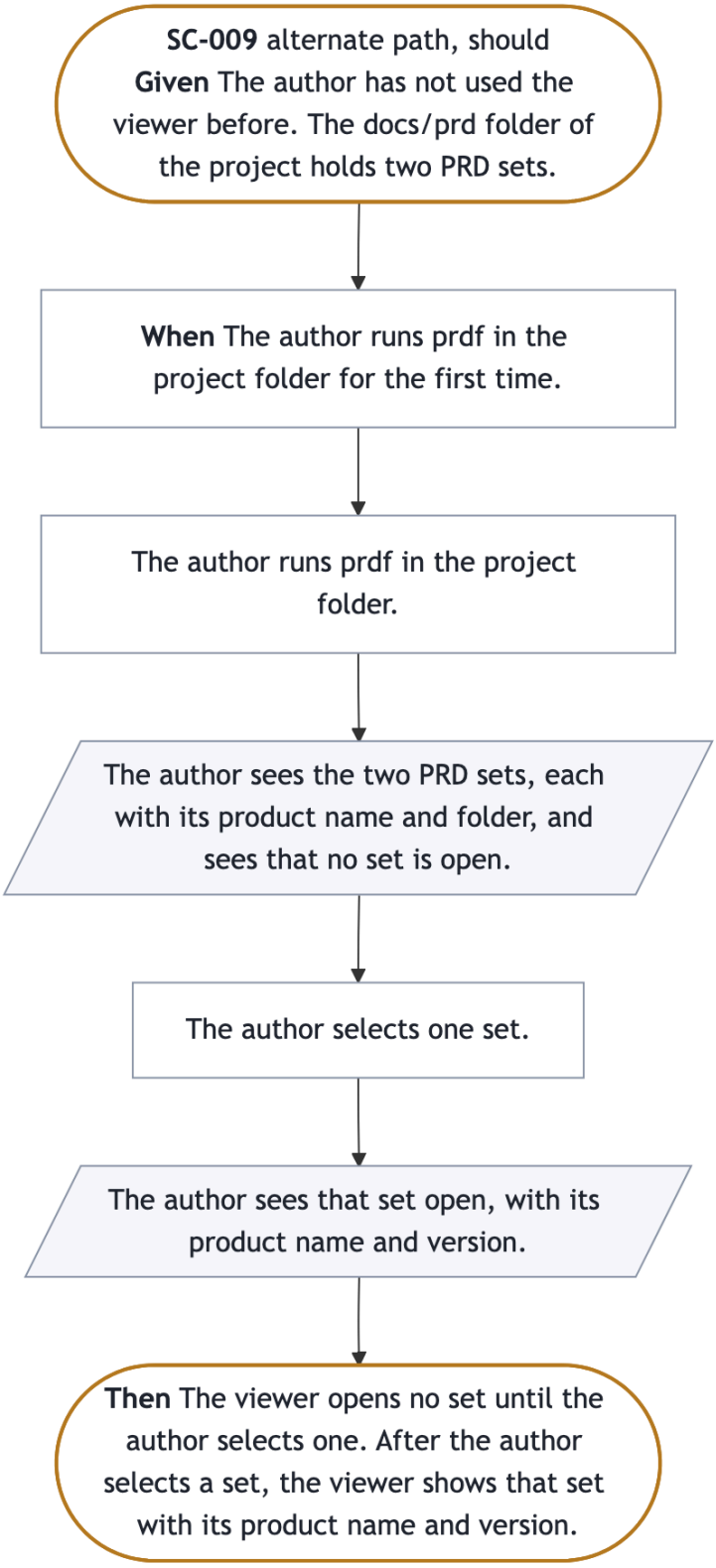
LC-001 lifecycle of A section of the PRD set



SC-007 scenario



SC-008 scenario



SC-009 scenario

WF-010 More than one PRD set in docs/prd

PRD Forge Viewer

Select a PRD set in /clients/work/src/docs/prd <1>

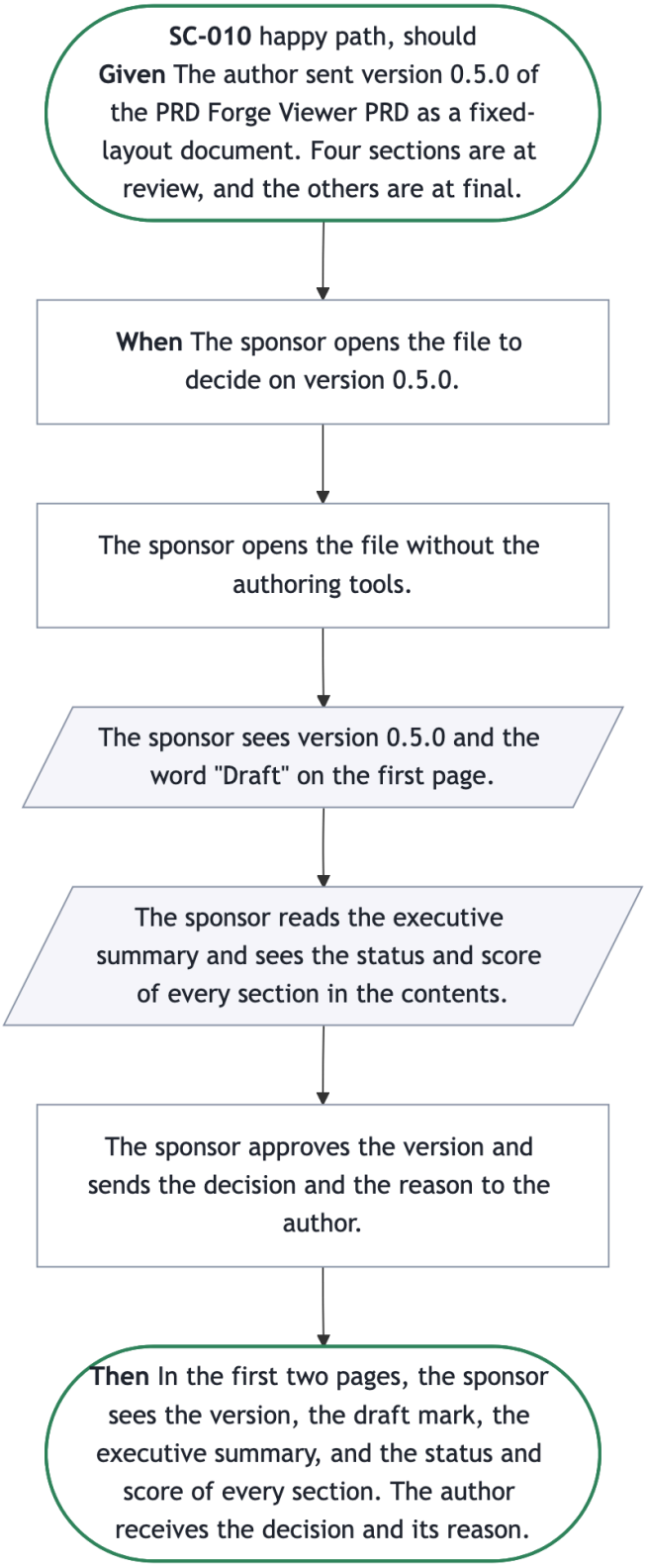
PRD sets in docs/prd <2>

Product	Location
› Portal	docs/prd/portal
› Portal Admin	docs/prd/portal-admin

Known PRD sets

Product	Location
› PRD Forge Viewer	/.../work/src/prd-forge-viewer
› PRD Forge	/.../work/src/prd-forge

WF-010 drawing



SC-010 scenario

WF-009 First page of an export

PRD Forge Viewer PRD page 1
DRAFT <1> Version 0.5.0 <2>

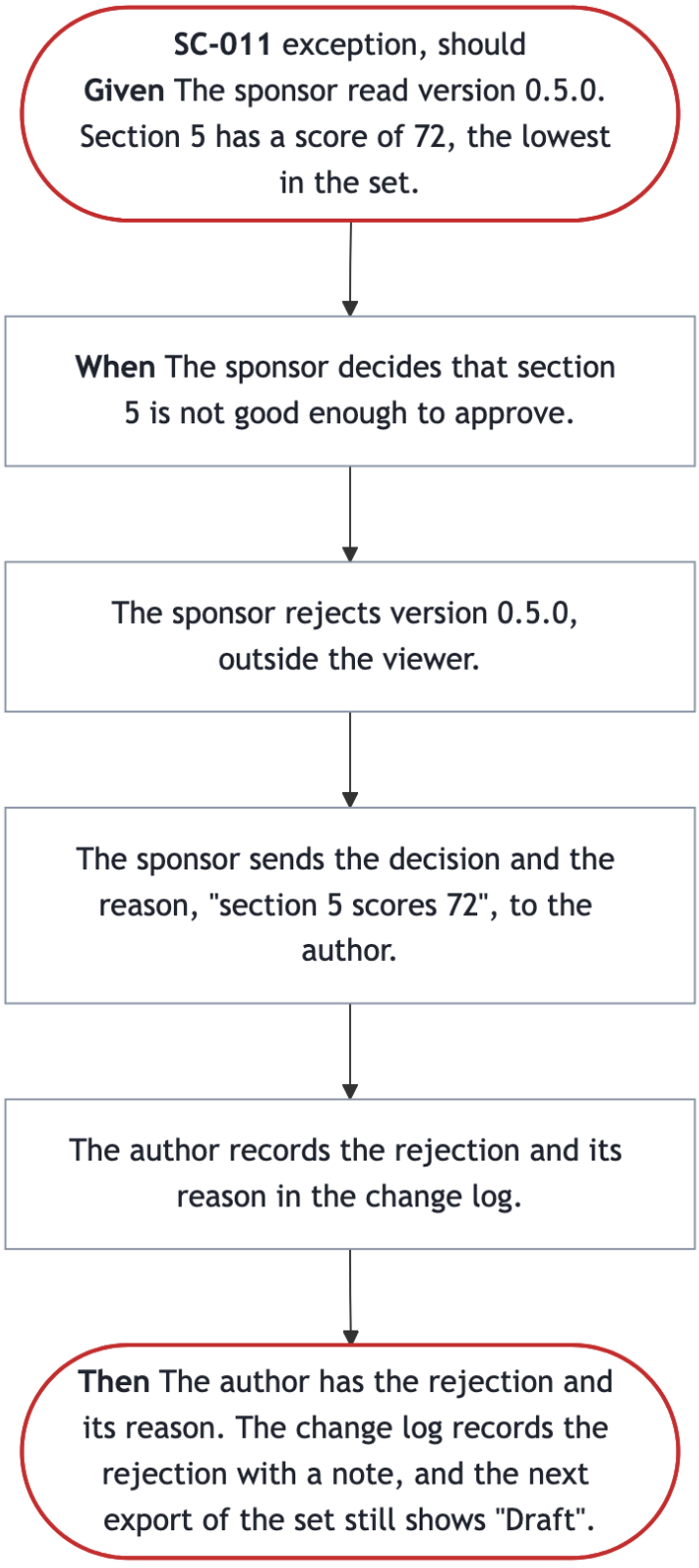
Executive summary <3>
PRD authors cannot read a PRD Forge set as one document or see every grade at once. ...

Contents <4>

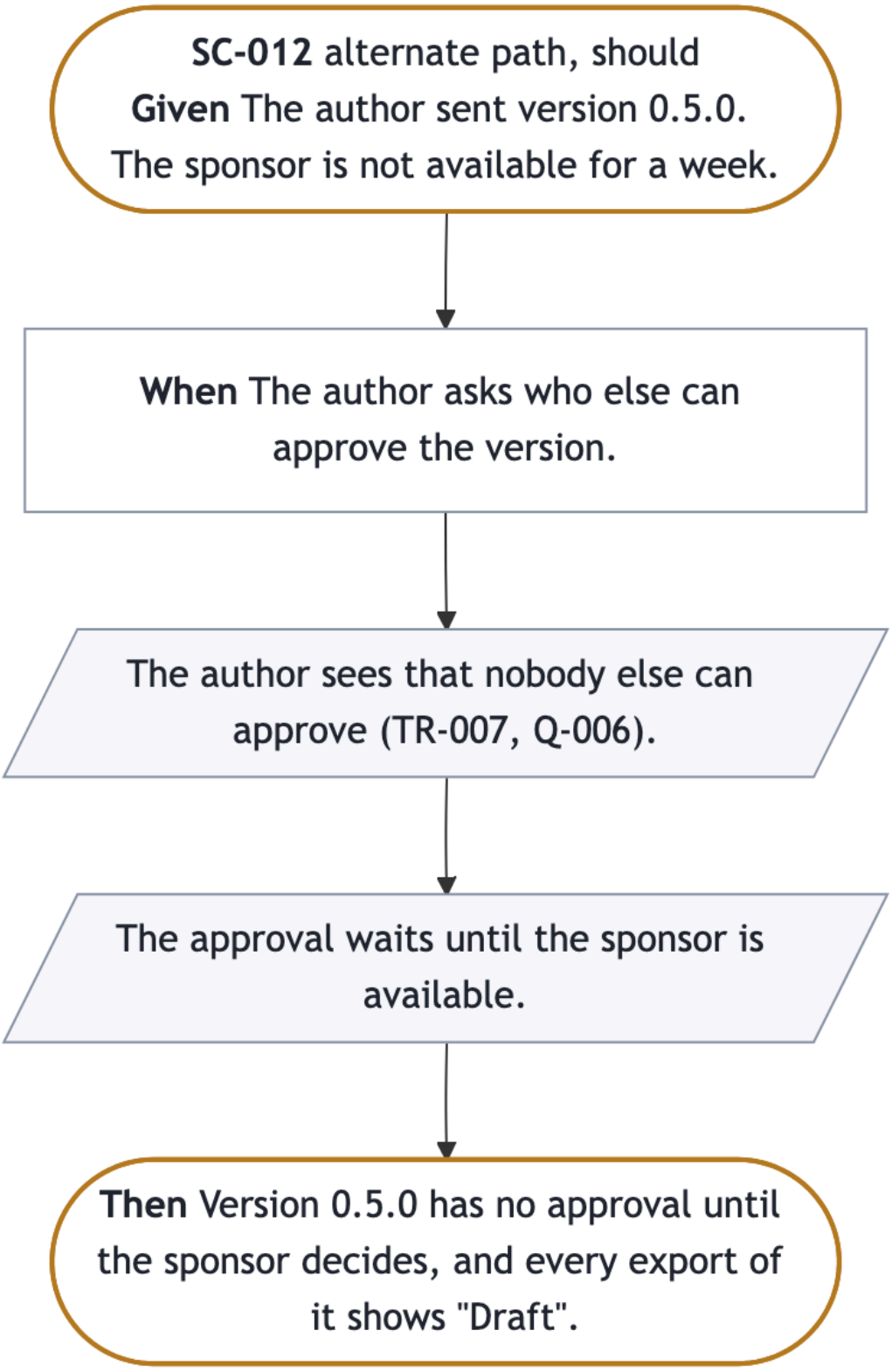
Section	Status	Score	Blk
1 Problem and opportunity	final	75	0
4 Users and personas	final	86	0
12 Open questions	draft	–	–
15 Change log	pending <5>	–	–

...





SC-011 scenario



SC-012 scenario

SC-001 is the happy path of the golden thread. It is the end-to-end acceptance test for release 1.

SC-005, SC-007, and SC-008 are on J-002, and SC-010 to SC-012 are on J-003, so their priority is should. SC-006 and SC-009 are should because their requirements (FR-002 and FR-024) are should. A should scenario is still in release 1, but release 1 can ship without it.

ID	JOURNEY	STAGE	VARIANT	SUMMARY
SC-001	J-001	ST-001	happy	The author fixes a weak section and sends a draft fixed-layout document to the sponsor
SC-002	J-001	ST-001	exception	The PRD set has pending sections and one unreadable section
SC-003	J-001	ST-004	exception	The authoring tools change a section while the author reads it
SC-004	J-001	ST-005	alternate	The author exports a set that is not complete
SC-005	J-002	ST-009	happy	A developer searches by category and exports two sections
SC-006	J-001	ST-001	alternate	The author reopens the viewer the next day
SC-007	J-002	ST-009	exception	A search finds no match
SC-008	J-002	ST-010	alternate	A developer exports a section that is still pending
SC-009	J-001	ST-001	alternate	The author runs the viewer for the first time, with two sets in docs/prd
SC-010	J-003	ST-011	happy	The sponsor reads the export and decides
SC-011	J-003	ST-012	exception	The sponsor rejects a version with a reason
SC-012	J-003	ST-012	alternate	The sponsor is not available, and the approval waits

SC-001. The author sends a draft fixed-layout document to the sponsor

The author opens the set, sees that section 4 has the lowest score (61), fixes it in the authoring tools, and sees the new score in the viewer. The author exports the whole set as a fixed-layout document with the Clay theme. Expected outcome: the sponsor's file shows version 0.1.0, the word "Draft", every section in order, and the status and score of each section.

SC-002. The set has pending sections and one unreadable section

Expected outcome: the set opens, all 18 documents are listed, the unreadable section is marked with its file name, and the other 17 can be read.

SC-003. A section changes while the author reads it

Expected outcome: the viewer shows score 75 and the new text without any action from the author. Section 8 sets the time limit.

SC-004. The author exports a set that is not complete

Expected outcome: the editable document shows "Draft" and the version on the first page, the status and score of every section in the contents list, and "not written yet" for each pending section.

SC-005. A developer searches by category and exports two sections

Expected outcome: the developer sees only the items that contain "export", best match first, and the team receives one file with only the two selected sections.

SC-006. The author reopens the viewer the next day

Expected outcome: the viewer opens the same PRD set as in the last session, and every section shows its current version, including changes made while the viewer was closed.

SC-007. A search finds no match

Expected outcome: the developer sees that no item contains "invoice", and sees no results (FR-008).

SC-008. A developer exports a section that is still pending

The developer exports two sections, and one is still pending. Expected outcome: the file has both sections, the pending one says that it is not written yet, and the export shows "Draft" (FR-012, FR-019, TR-005). This answers Q-008.

SC-009. The author runs the viewer for the first time

The author runs prdf for the first time where docs/prd holds two PRD sets. Expected outcome: the viewer lists both sets and opens neither until the author selects one (FR-024, WF-010).

SC-010. The sponsor reads the export and decides

The sponsor opens version 0.5.0 without the authoring tools. Expected outcome: the first two pages show the version, the draft mark, the summary, and every grade, and the author receives the decision and its reason (FR-014, FR-019, WF-009, TR-007).

SC-011. The sponsor rejects a version with a reason

The sponsor rejects version 0.5.0 because section 5 scores 72. Expected outcome: the author has the reason, and the change log records the rejection with a note (TR-007).

SC-012. The sponsor is not available

Nobody else approves. Expected outcome: the version waits for the sponsor, and every export shows "Draft" (TR-007, Q-006).

LC-001. The lifecycle of a section

A section moves from pending to draft when the author writes it, to review at a score of 70 or more with 0 blocking defects, and to final when the sponsor approves the version. A change to an approved section returns it to review. The author makes each move in the authoring tools, and the sponsor (PER-004) makes the move to final. The viewer only shows the state.

Scenarios

> **SC-001**
>
> CONTEXT — The PRD Forge Viewer PRD set has 18 documents. The root document and 4 sections are at draft, and 13 sections are at pending. Section 4 has a score of 61 and 0 blocking defects.
>
> JOURNEY — J-001
>
> STAGE — ST-001

STAGES
- ST-001
- ST-002
- ST-003
- ST-004
- ST-005
- ST-006
- ST-007

PERSONA: PER-001

VARIANT: happy

PRIORITY: must

TRIGGER: The author wants to send version 0.1.0 to the sponsor for early comments.

COURSE
- The author opens the PRD set and sees the product name, version 0.1.0, and the status of all 18 documents.
- The author sees that section 4 has a score of 61, the lowest of the graded sections.
- The author goes directly to section 4 and reads it.
- The author fixes section 4 in the authoring tools. The viewer shows the new text and the new score without any action from the author.
- The author exports the whole PRD set as one fixed-layout document with the Clay theme.
- The author sends the file to the product sponsor.
- The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools and sees on the first page that version 0.1.0 is a draft.

EXPECTED OUTCOME: The sponsor has one fixed-layout document that shows version 0.1.0, the word "Draft", every section in order, and the status and score of each section.

SC-002

CONTEXT: The PRD set has 18 files. Thirteen sections are at pending and fail the authoring tools' check because they have no content yet. One section has a header that cannot be read.

JOURNEY: J-001

STAGE: ST-001

PERSONA: PER-001

VARIANT: exception

PRIORITY: must

TRIGGER: The author opens the PRD set.

COURSE
- The author opens the PRD set.
- The author sees all 18 documents in order, with the status of each.
- The author sees which section has a header that cannot be read, and the name of its file.
- The author reads the other 17 documents as usual.

EXPECTED OUTCOME: The PRD set opens. All 18 documents are listed. The one unreadable section is marked as unreadable with its file name, and the 17 other documents can be read.

SC-003

CONTEXT	The author reads section 4 in the viewer. Section 4 shows a score of 61. At the same time, the authoring tools rewrite section 4 and grade it at 75.
JOURNEY	J-001
STAGE	ST-004
PERSONA	PER-001
VARIANT	exception
PRIORITY	must
SITUATION	concurrent
TRIGGER	The authoring tools save the new version of section 4.
COURSE	• The author reads section 4 in the viewer. • The authoring tools save a new version of section 4. • The author sees the new text and the score 75, without any action in the viewer. • The author sees that section 4 changed.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	The viewer shows score 75 and the new text of section 4, and the author did nothing to get it. Section 8 sets the time limit.

SC-004

CONTEXT	The PRD set has the root document and 4 sections at draft, and 13 sections at pending. The engineering lead wants an early copy.
JOURNEY	J-001
STAGE	ST-005
PERSONA	PER-001
VARIANT	alternate
PRIORITY	must
TRIGGER	The author exports the PRD set before the interview covers all sections.
COURSE	• The author selects the whole PRD set, the editable document format, and the Ice Snowstorm theme. • The author saves the file and sends it to the engineering lead. • The engineering lead opens the file without the authoring tools.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	The file shows the word "Draft" and version 0.1.0 on the first page. The contents list shows the status and score of every section. Each pending section says that it is not written yet.

SC-005

CONTEXT	The PRD set has its functional requirements and scenarios written. The developer starts work on the export feature.
JOURNEY	J-002
STAGE	ST-009
PERSONA	PER-002
VARIANT	happy
PRIORITY	should
TRIGGER	The developer needs the requirements and scenarios about export.

COURSE

- The developer enters the search term "export" and selects the category "functional requirements".
- The developer sees the matching requirements, best match first, each with its id and section.
- The developer changes the category to "all" and sees the matching scenarios as well.
- The developer exports the user journeys and functional requirements sections as one editable document and sends it to the team.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The developer sees only the items that contain "export", best match first, each with its id and section. The team receives one file with only the two selected sections.

SC-006

CONTEXT

Yesterday the author read the PRD Forge Viewer PRD set and closed the viewer. Overnight the authoring tools changed section 6 from pending to draft.

JOURNEY

J-001

STAGE

ST-001

PERSONA

PER-001

VARIANT

alternate

PRIORITY

should

SITUATION

return

LIFECYCLES

- LC-001

TRIGGER

The author opens the viewer the next day.

COURSE

- The author opens the viewer.
- The author sees the same PRD set as yesterday, without selecting it again.
- The author sees section 6 at draft, with its new text.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The viewer opens the same PRD set as in the last session, and every section shows its current version, including section 6 at draft.

SC-007 · The PRD set has its functional requirements and scenarios written.

JOURNEY

J-002

STAGE

ST-009

PERSONA

PER-002

VARIANT

exception

PRIORITY

should

TRIGGER

The developer searches for a term that no item contains.

COURSE

- The developer enters the search term "invoice" and selects the category "all".
- The viewer finds no item that contains "invoice".

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The developer sees that no item contains "invoice", and sees no results.

SC-008

CONTEXT The PRD set has 18 documents. The functional requirements section is at final, and the release plan section is still at pending.

JOURNEY J-002

STAGE ST-010

PERSONA PER-002

VARIANT alternate

PRIORITY should

BRANCHES FROM

SCENARIO	SC-005
STEP	4

TRIGGER The developer needs both sections for the team.

COURSE

- The developer selects the functional requirements section and the release plan section.
- The developer exports them as one editable document.
- The developer opens the file and sees both sections. The release plan section says that it is not written yet.

EXPECTED OUTCOME The file has both selected sections, in reading order. The pending section shows its status and says that it is not written yet, and the export shows "Draft".

SC-009

CONTEXT The author has not used the viewer before. The docs/prd folder of the project holds two PRD sets.

JOURNEY J-001

STAGE ST-001

PERSONA PER-001

VARIANT alternate

PRIORITY should

SITUATION first-use

BRANCHES FROM

SCENARIO	SC-001
STEP	1

SHOWN IN screen

WIREFRAMES

- WF-010

TRIGGER The author runs prdf in the project folder for the first time.

COURSE

- The author runs prdf in the project folder.
- The author sees the two PRD sets, each with its product name and folder, and sees that no set is open.
- The author selects one set.
- The author sees that set open, with its product name and version.

EXPECTED OUTCOME The viewer opens no set until the author selects one. After the author selects a set, the viewer shows that set with its product name and version.

SC-010

CONTEXT The author sent version 0.5.0 of the PRD Forge Viewer PRD as a fixed-layout document. Four sections are at review, and the others are at final.

JOURNEY	J-003
STAGE	ST-011
STAGES	• ST-011 • ST-012
PERSONA	PER-004
VARIANT	happy
PRIORITY	should
SHOWN IN	report
WIREFRAMES	• WF-009
TRIGGER	The sponsor opens the file to decide on version 0.5.0.
COURSE	• The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools. • The sponsor sees version 0.5.0 and the word "Draft" on the first page. • The sponsor reads the executive summary and sees the status and score of every section in the contents. • The sponsor approves the version and sends the decision and the reason to the author.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	In the first two pages, the sponsor sees the version, the draft mark, the executive summary, and the status and score of every section. The author receives the decision and its reason.

SC-011 · The sponsor read version 0.5.0. Section 5 has a score of 72, the lowest in the set.

JOURNEY	J-003
STAGE	ST-012
PERSONA	PER-004
VARIANT	exception
PRIORITY	should
BRANCHES FROM	SCENARIO: SC-010 STEP: 4
TRIGGER	The sponsor decides that section 5 is not good enough to approve.
COURSE	• The sponsor rejects version 0.5.0, outside the viewer. • The sponsor sends the decision and the reason, "section 5 scores 72", to the author. • The author records the rejection and its reason in the change log.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	The author has the rejection and its reason. The change log records the rejection with a note, and the next export of the set still shows "Draft".

SC-012 · The author sent version 0.5.0. The sponsor is not available for a week.

JOURNEY	J-003
STAGE	ST-012
PERSONA	PER-004
VARIANT	alternate
PRIORITY	should
BRANCHES FROM	SCENARIO: SC-010 STEP: 4
TRIGGER	The author asks who else can approve the version.
COURSE	• The author sees that nobody else can approve (TR-007, Q-006). • The approval waits until the sponsor is available.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	Version 0.5.0 has no approval until the sponsor decides, and every export of it shows "Draft".

Lifecycles

LC-001 · A section of the PRD set

STATES	**pending** MEANING: The section is not written yet. **draft** MEANING: The section is written, and it is not graded high enough for review. **review** MEANING: The section has a score of 70 or more and no blocking defects. **final** MEANING: The sponsor approved the version that holds this section.
INITIAL	pending
FINAL	• final

TRANSITIONS

FROM	pending
TO	draft
WHEN	The author writes the section in the authoring tools.
RULE	The section has content that the authoring tools can read.
BY	PER-001

FROM	draft
TO	review
WHEN	A grading pass in the authoring tools gives the section its grade.
RULE	A score of 70 or more and 0 blocking defects.
BY	PER-001

FROM	review
TO	final
WHEN	The sponsor approves the version.
RULE	The change log records the approval.
BY	PER-004

FROM	final
TO	review
WHEN	The author changes an approved section.
RULE	The section stays at review until the sponsor approves the new version.
BY	PER-001

SECTION 6

Scope

FINAL 92/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Release 1 delivers J-001, the golden thread, from ST-001 to ST-005 in the viewer. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer, and the author and the stakeholders use the tools that they already use. Release 1 also lets a developer do the work of J-002: search is part of ST-003, and the export of selected sections is part of ST-005.

ID	IN SCOPE FOR RELEASE 1	STAGE
IN-001	Open a PRD set and see every document's status; reopen the same set next time	ST-001
IN-002	See status, score, blocking count, and grade date of every section	ST-002
IN-003	Go directly to any section and read it	ST-003
IN-004	Search by term in one or more categories, best matches first	ST-003
IN-005	See changes from the authoring tools without any action	ST-004
IN-006	Export the whole set or selected sections as a fixed-layout document (PDF) or an editable document (.docx), or print, with version and status	ST-005
IN-007	Select a built-in theme, or make, change, and delete custom themes	ST-005
IN-008	Export only the sections that a developer selects	ST-005

Out of scope for release 1

ID	ITEM	REVISIT WHEN
OUT-001	Editing section text in the viewer	The PRD owner decides at the release 2 review, on 2026-11-06
OUT-002	The findings behind each grade	Release 2, on 2026-11-06, with FR-025 (D-002 delivered).
OUT-003	Operating systems other than macOS. The only test computer is an Apple silicon Mac with 16 GB of memory	The PRD owner decides at the release 2 review, on 2026-11-06
OUT-004	Text size, search results kept in view, and links to backlog stories	Release 2, on 2026-11-06, with FR-026 to FR-028.

Non-goals

NON-GOAL	REASON
We are not building a tool that writes or grades a PRD.	The authoring tools do that, and the viewer only reads and exports their output.
We are not building a way to send files to stakeholders.	The author sends the export with the tools the author already uses.
We are not building comments inside the viewer.	Stakeholders reply outside the viewer, and the author records the result in the authoring tools.
We are not building a view of several PRD sets at once.	Every journey works on one PRD. No persona needs to compare two sets, and FR-022 already switches between sets.
We are not building accounts, cloud copies, or shared links.	Everything stays on the author's computer (NFR-005).
We are not building a viewer for PRDs in other formats.	The viewer reads only the PRD Forge format (C-003).

In scope

IN-001

SUMMARY Open a PRD set and see the product name, the version, the executive summary, and the status of every document. The next session opens the same PRD set.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-001

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-021
- FR-022
- FR-024

IN-002

SUMMARY See the status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section in one view.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-002

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-004

IN-003 · Go directly to any section and read it.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-003

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-005
- FR-023

IN-004

SUMMARY: Search the PRD set by term, in one or more categories or in all, and see the best matches first.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-003

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-008
- FR-007

IN-005

SUMMARY: See each change that the authoring tools make to a section, without any action from the author.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-004

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-009

IN-006

SUMMARY: Export the whole PRD set or selected sections as a fixed-layout document or an editable document, or print it. The fixed-layout document is PDF (ISO 32000). The editable document is a .docx file (ISO/IEC 29500). The readers already open these formats without installing anything (A-001). The export shows the version and the status of the PRD and of each section.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-005

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-013
- FR-014
- FR-019

IN-007

SUMMARY: Select an export theme. The viewer includes the built-in themes, and the author can make, change, and delete custom themes.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-005

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-020

IN-008 · Export only the sections that a developer selects.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-005

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-012

Out of scope

OUT-001 · Editing the text of a section in the viewer (Q-005).

REVISIT: The PRD owner decides at the release 2 review, on 2026-11-06, if editing goes into a release.

OUT-002

SUMMARY	Showing the findings behind each grade, such as what is missing and what to improve (Q-004).
REVISIT	The authoring tools now record the findings (D-002 delivered). Release 2 shows them (FR-025), on 2026-11-06.

OUT-003

SUMMARY	Operating systems other than macOS. Release 1 runs on macOS only, on the only test computer, an Apple silicon Mac with 16 GB of memory. The PRD owner decided this on item ADV-03 of the HLD review (change log, version 0.3.2).
REVISIT	The PRD owner decides at the release 2 review, on 2026-11-06, if another operating system goes into a release.

OUT-004

SUMMARY	A larger or smaller text size, search results kept in view while reading, and links between a requirement and the backlog stories that build it.
REVISIT	Release 2 delivers them (FR-026, FR-027, and FR-028), on 2026-11-06.

SECTION 7

Functional requirements

FINAL 81/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Each requirement uses MoSCoW priority: must, should, could, or won't.

ID	USER	CAPABILITY	PRIORITY	STAGE
FR-001	PER-001	Open a PRD set and see its contents	must	ST-001
FR-002	PER-001	Return to the same PRD set in the next session	should	ST-001
FR-003	PER-001	Open a set with incomplete or unreadable documents	must	ST-001
FR-004	PER-001	See the grades of all sections together	must	ST-002
FR-005	PER-001	Go directly to any section	must	ST-003
FR-006	PER-001	Move to the previous or next section. Dropped: FR-005 and FR-023 cover it	wont	ST-003
FR-007	PER-002	Follow a reference to the item it names	should	ST-003
FR-008	PER-002	Search by term and category	must	ST-003
FR-009	PER-001	See changes from the authoring tools without any action	must	ST-004
FR-010	PER-001	Export as a fixed-layout document	must	ST-005
FR-011	PER-001	Export as an editable document	should	ST-005
FR-012	PER-002	Export only selected sections	must	ST-005
FR-013	PER-001	Print the set or selected sections	should	ST-005
FR-014	PER-004	See the version, and if it is a draft, in an export	must	ST-005
FR-015	PER-001	Select a built-in export theme	must	ST-005
FR-016	PER-001	Make a custom export theme	should	ST-005
FR-017	PER-001	Change a custom export theme	should	ST-005
FR-018	PER-001	Delete a custom export theme	should	ST-005
FR-019	PER-003	See the status of every section in an export, and the grades when included	should	ST-005
FR-020	PER-001	Keep custom themes from one session to the next	should	ST-005
FR-021	PER-001	Start the viewer from a terminal with prdf	must	ST-001
FR-022	PER-001	Choose a PRD set from remembered locations	should	ST-001
FR-023	PER-001	Select one item of a section and read it	must	ST-003
FR-024	PER-001	Choose one PRD set when docs/prd holds more than one	should	ST-001
FR-025	PER-001	See the findings behind the grade of a section, in release 2	wont	ST-002

ID	USER	CAPABILITY	PRIORITY	STAGE
FR-026	PER-001	Make the text larger or smaller, in release 2	wont	ST-003
FR-027	PER-002	Keep search results in view while reading, in release 2	wont	ST-003
FR-028	PER-002	Move between a requirement and its backlog stories, in release 2	wont	ST-003

FR-001. Open a PRD set and see its contents

Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and all 18 documents in order, each with its status.

FR-002. Return to the same PRD set in the next session

The same PRD set opens without any selection, and each section shows its current version.

FR-003. Open a set with incomplete or unreadable documents

All documents are listed. Pending sections show pending. An unreadable section is marked with its file name, and the other documents can be read.

FR-004. See the grades of all sections together

The author sees status, score, blocking count, and grade date for every section. A section with no grade shows that it is not graded.

FR-005. Go directly to any section

From any section, the author reaches any other section in one action.

FR-006. Move to the previous or next section

Dropped on 2026-10-26. FR-005 and FR-023 move the author to any section and item, so the viewer has no previous and next links. The ID stays, and nobody reuses it.

FR-007. Follow a reference to the item it names

From FR-004, the developer follows the reference to ST-002 in J-001.

FR-008. Search by term and category

Each result shows its id, title, section, and a relevance score from 0 to 100, highest first. Selecting a result opens the item. A search with no match says so.

FR-009. See changes from the authoring tools without any action

The author sees a new score and new text without any action, within the time limit in section 8.

FR-010. Export as a fixed-layout document

One fixed-layout document (IN-006) holds every document in order. A reader opens it without the authoring tools.

FR-011. Export as an editable document

One editable document (IN-006) holds every document in order. A reader opens it without the authoring tools.

FR-012. Export only selected sections

The file contains only the selected sections, in reading order.

FR-013. Print the set or selected sections

The printed copy matches the fixed-layout export in documents, order, and draft mark.

FR-014. See the version, and if it is a draft, in an export

The first page shows the version and "Draft".

FR-015. Select a built-in export theme

The built-in themes are Ice Snowstorm and Clay. The acceptance criteria give the colors and fonts of each.

FR-016. Make a custom export theme

The author selects a page color, a text color, a heading color, an accent color, and a text font and a heading font from serif, sans-serif, and monospace. Exports carry their fonts, so every reader sees the same fonts.

FR-017. Change a custom export theme

Later exports use the changed values. Built-in themes cannot change.

FR-018. Delete a custom export theme

The deleted theme is no longer available. Built-in themes cannot be deleted.

FR-019. See the status of every section in an export

The contents list shows the status of every section. Each pending section says that it is not written yet. An export leaves out the score and the blocking defects of each section, unless the author selects to include them.

FR-020. Keep custom themes from one session to the next

A custom theme is still available, with the same values, after the viewer restarts.

FR-021. Start the viewer from a terminal with prdf

The command `prdf` opens the viewer on the PRD set in the current directory, or on the path that the author gives.

FR-022. Choose a PRD set from remembered locations

The viewer remembers every PRD set location that it opened. In a folder with no PRD set, the author picks one from that list.

FR-023. Select one item of a section and read it

The author asks for the items of a section, sees them by id, and selects one item to read it with the status and grade of its section.

FR-024. Choose one of several PRD sets

When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, prdf reopens the set that was open in the last session. If none of them was open before, the viewer shows a list of the sets it found, and the author selects one. The PRD owner decided this on 2026-10-26.

FR-025. See the findings behind the grade of a section

The author sees the blocking defects and the items to raise the grade of a section. The authoring tools record these findings (D-002). FR-025 is in release 2 (REL-002) with FR-026 to FR-028. All four have priority wont, because the priority says what release 1 must handle, and release 1 does not have it.

FR-026. Make the text larger or smaller

The author changes the text size in steps and returns to the normal size in one action. The viewer keeps the size for the next session. The PRD owner added this on 2026-10-30.

FR-027. Keep search results in view while reading

Search is hidden until the developer asks for it. The developer can keep it in view, so that the results stay while the developer opens one result after another. The PRD owner added this on 2026-10-30.

FR-028. Move between a requirement and its backlog stories

When a backlog made from the PRD set is next to it, a requirement shows the stories that build it, and a story shows its requirements. Each link opens its item. The PRD owner added this on 2026-10-30 (owner request 199).

> **FR-001 · Open a PRD set and see its contents**
>
> | | |
> |---|---|
> | SHOWN IN | screen |
> | USER | PER-001 |
> | OUTCOME | The author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and every document of the set in order, each with its status. |
> | ACCEPTANCE | • Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and all 18 documents in order, each with its status.
• Given a folder that holds no PRD set, when the author opens it, then the author sees that the folder holds no PRD set, with the folder name. |
> | PRIORITY | must |
> | JOURNEY STAGE | ST-001 |
> | OBJECTIVE | O-001 |
> | SOURCE | Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001 |

FR-002 · Return to the same PRD set in the next session

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author continues with the same PRD set without selecting it again.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author closed the viewer while a PRD set was open, when the author opens the viewer again, then the same PRD set is open without any selection. • Given a section changed while the viewer was closed, when the author opens the viewer again, then the author sees the current version of that section.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-006

FR-003 · Open a PRD set that has incomplete or unreadable documents

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads every readable document and sees which documents cannot be read.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 13 pending sections that have no content, when the author opens it, then all 18 documents are listed and each pending section shows its status as pending. • Given one section that cannot be read, when the author opens the set, then the author sees that section marked as unreadable with its file name, and can read the other 17 documents.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	SC-002

FR-004 · See the grades of all sections together

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section at the same time.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given section 4 has score 61 and 0 blocking defects and section 3 has score 75 and 1 blocking defect, when the author views the grades, then the author sees both sections with those values and their grade dates. • Given a section that has no grade, when the author views the grades, then that section shows that it is not graded.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-002
OBJECTIVE	O-002
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; P-003

FR-005 · Go directly to any section

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads the selected section without opening other documents first.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author is reading the problem and opportunity section, when the author selects the functional requirements section, then the author sees it in one action. • Given a section at pending that has not been interviewed, when the author selects it, then the author sees the section with its status pending.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; P-001

FR-006 · Move to the previous or the next section in reading order

USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads the PRD set from start to end, one section after the other.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author is reading section 4, when the author moves to the next section, then the author sees section 5, user journeys. • Given the author is reading section 4, when the author moves to the previous section, then the author sees section 3, objectives and success metrics. • Given the author is reading the last section, when the author tries to move to the next section, then the author stays on the last section and sees that it is the last one. • Given the author is reading the root document, when the author tries to move to the previous section, then the author stays on the root document and sees that it is the first one.
PRIORITY	wont
SHOWN IN	none
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26. Dropped on 2026-10-26 by the PRD owner: FR-005 and FR-023 move the author to any section.

FR-007 · Follow a reference from one item to the item it names

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer reads the related item, such as the journey stage that a requirement serves.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given requirement FR-004 names stage ST-002, when the developer follows that reference, then the developer sees stage ST-002 in J-001. • Given an item names an id that is in no section of the PRD set, when the developer reads that item, then the id shows as plain text that the developer cannot follow.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	J-002

FR-008 · Search the PRD set by term, in one or more categories or in all categories

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer sees the matching items, most relevant first, each with its id and section.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the term "export" and the category functional requirements, when the developer searches, then the developer sees only the functional requirements that contain "export", each with its id and section. • Given the term "export" and the categories functional requirements and scenarios, when the developer searches, then the developer sees only functional requirements and scenarios that contain "export". • Given the same term and the category "all", when the developer searches, then the developer sees matching items from every section, including scenarios. • Given item A has "export" in its title and item B has "export" only once in its text, when the developer searches for "export", then item A is above item B. • Given a search with matches, when the developer views the results, then each result shows its id, its title, its section, and a relevance score from 0 to 100, highest first. • Given a list of results, when the developer selects one result, then the developer sees that item in its section. • Given a term that no item contains, when the developer searches, then the developer sees that there are no matches.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-005

FR-009 · See changes that the authoring tools make, without any action

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the current version of each section without any action.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author reads section 4 with score 61, when the authoring tools save section 4 with score 75, then the author sees score 75 and the new text without any action, within the time limit in NFR-002. • Given the author reads section 4, when the authoring tools save a new version of it, then the author sees that section 4 changed. • Given the authoring tools change a section the author is not reading, when the author views the grades, then that section shows its new status and score.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-004
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-003

FR-010 · Export the PRD set as a fixed-layout document (IN-006)

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has one fixed-layout document that a reader opens with software already on the computer, without the authoring tools.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author exports the whole set as a fixed-layout document, then one file in the format that IN-006 names contains every document in order, and the sponsor opens it without the authoring tools. • Given the author picks a folder where the file cannot be written, when the author exports the whole set as a fixed-layout document, then the author sees that the export was not done, with the reason.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001

FR-011 · Export the PRD set as an editable document (IN-006)

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has one editable document that a reader opens with software already on the computer, without the authoring tools.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author exports the whole set as an editable document, then one file in the format that IN-006 names contains every document in order, and the engineering lead opens it in a word processor without the authoring tools. • Given the author picks a folder where the file cannot be written, when the author exports the whole set as an editable document, then the author sees that the export was not done, with the reason.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-004

FR-012 · Export only selected sections

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer has one file with only the selected sections.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the user journeys section and the functional requirements section are the only sections selected, when the developer exports them, then the file contains only those two sections, in reading order. • Given no section is selected, when the developer tries to export, then the export does not start until the developer selects at least one section.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-005

FR-013 · Print the PRD set or selected sections

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has a printed copy with the same content as the export.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the whole PRD set is selected, when the author prints it, then the printed copy has the same documents, order, and draft mark as the fixed-layout export. • Given the scope section is the only section selected, when the author prints, then the printed copy contains only the scope section. • Given no section is selected, when the author tries to print, then printing does not start until the author selects at least one section.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-014 · See the version of the PRD, and if it is a draft, in an export

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-004
OUTCOME	The sponsor knows which version is in the file, and if it is a draft.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given version 0.1.0 with sections at draft, when the sponsor opens the export, then the first page shows version 0.1.0 and the word "Draft". • Given version 1.0.0 with the root and every section at final, when the sponsor opens the export, then the first page shows version 1.0.0 and does not show the word "Draft".
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001, SC-004

FR-015 · Select an export theme from the built-in themes

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The export has the colors and fonts of the selected theme.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the built-in theme Clay, when the author exports with Clay, then the file has page color FAF9F5, text color 3D3D3A, heading color 141413, accent color D97757, a serif font for headings, and a sans-serif font for text. • Given the built-in theme Ice Snowstorm, when the author exports with it, then the file has page color F3F6FB, text color 111111, heading color 0B1F4B, accent color 1D4E89, and a sans-serif font for headings and text. • Given the author has not selected a theme, when the author exports, then the file uses the built-in theme Ice Snowstorm.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-016 · Make a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author exports with colors and fonts that the author selected.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author makes a theme named "Acme" with a page color, a text color, a heading color, an accent color, a text font, and a heading font, each font chosen from serif, sans-serif, and monospace, when the author exports with "Acme", then the file uses those colors and fonts. • Given an export with the theme "Acme", when a reader opens it on a computer that does not have those fonts installed, then the reader sees the same fonts as the author. • Given a theme with a blank name, or a color that is not six hexadecimal digits, when the author saves it, then the theme is not saved and the author sees the reason.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-017 · Change a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	Later exports use the changed colors and fonts.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the custom theme "Acme", when the author changes its accent color and exports, then the file uses the new accent color. • Given a built-in theme, when the author tries to change it, then the built-in theme stays as it was.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-018 · Delete a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The deleted theme is no longer available for export.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the custom theme "Acme", when the author deletes it, then "Acme" is no longer available to select. • Given a built-in theme, when the author tries to delete it, then the built-in theme is still available.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-019 · See the status of every section in an export, and the grades when the author includes them

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-003
OUTCOME	The engineering lead knows which sections are finished before reading them.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given 13 pending sections, when the engineering lead opens the export, then the contents list shows the status of every section. • Given an export that the author made with no change to the options, when the engineering lead opens it, then it shows no score and no number of blocking defects. • Given that the author selected to include the grades, when the engineering lead opens the export, then the contents list also shows the score and the number of blocking defects of every section. • Given a pending section, when the engineering lead reaches it in the export, then the section says that it is not written yet.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	SC-004

FR-020 · Keep custom export themes from one session to the next

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author uses the same custom themes after the viewer restarts.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author made the custom theme "Acme", when the author closes and reopens the viewer, then "Acme" is available to select, with the same colors and fonts. • Given the saved settings of the viewer cannot be read, when the author opens the viewer, then the built-in themes are available to select.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-021 · Start the viewer from a terminal with the command prdf

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the PRD set of the current directory in the viewer, with no other step.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the current directory contains docs/prd with one PRD set, when the author runs prdf, then the viewer opens and shows that PRD set. • Given the author runs prdf with the path of a PRD set, when the viewer opens, then it shows that PRD set. • Given the current directory contains no PRD set, when the author runs prdf, then the author sees that no PRD set was found there, and sees the list of known PRD set locations (FR-022).
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26. The PRD owner keeps the name docs/prd on 2026-10-27, because it is the folder that the authoring tools use and that the author sees.

FR-022 · Choose a PRD set from the locations the viewer remembers

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author opens any PRD set opened before, without typing or finding its path.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author opened PRD sets in two different folders before, when the author opens a folder with no PRD set, then the author sees both locations, each with its product name. • Given the list of known locations, when the author selects one, then the viewer opens that PRD set. • Given a known location whose PRD set no longer exists, when the author sees the list, then that location is marked as not found.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-023 · Select one item of a section and read it without the whole section

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads one item, such as a persona or a requirement, without reading the whole section first.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the users and personas section with PER-001 to PER-005, when the author asks for the items of that section, then the author sees the five persona ids. • Given the five persona ids of that section are in view, when the author selects PER-001, then the author sees PER-001 with the status and grade of its section. • Given a section with no items, when the author opens it, then the author sees the whole section and no list of items.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-024 · Choose one PRD set when the docs/prd folder holds more than one

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author opens the intended PRD set without typing its path.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the current directory contains docs/prd with two PRD sets, and neither set was open in the last session, when the author runs prdf, then the author sees both sets, each with its product name and folder, and the viewer opens neither set. • Given the current directory contains docs/prd with two PRD sets, and one of them was open in the last session, when the author runs prdf, then the viewer opens that set. • Given that list, when the author selects one set, then the viewer opens that PRD set.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-26 (HLD review ADV-02)

FR-025 · See the findings behind the grade of a section

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees what is missing in a section and what to improve, without the authoring tools.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given section 7 has a grade with 1 blocking defect and 2 items to raise the grade, when the author views the findings of section 7, then the author sees the blocking defect and the 2 items. • Given a section with no recorded findings, when the author views its findings, then the author sees that no findings are recorded.
PRIORITY	wont
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-002
OBJECTIVE	O-002
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-27; OUT-002, D-002

FR-026 · Make the text larger or smaller

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads the PRD set at the text size that the author picked, and the next session opens at that size.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a section is open at the normal text size, when the author makes the text larger two times, then the text of the section is larger than before. • Given a larger text size, when the author returns to the normal size, then the text is at the normal size again. • Given the author made the text larger and closed the viewer, when the author opens the viewer again, then the text has the same larger size.
PRIORITY	wont
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-30

FR-027 · Keep search results in view while reading the items they find

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer opens one search result after another without searching again, and hides search when it is not needed.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given search is hidden, when the developer asks for search, then the developer can type a term at once. • Given search is kept in view and shows the results of "export", when the developer opens two results one after the other, then the results of "export" stay in view the whole time. • Given search is not kept in view, when the developer opens a result, then search is hidden and the item is shown.
PRIORITY	wont
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-30

FR-028 · Move between a requirement and the backlog stories that build it

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer goes from a requirement to the stories that build it, and from a story back to its requirements, in one action each way.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a backlog next to the PRD set in which US-008 builds FR-005, when the developer views FR-005, then the developer sees US-008 and can open it. • Given that backlog, when the developer views US-008, then the developer sees FR-005 and can open it. • Given a PRD set with no backlog next to it, when the developer views FR-005, then the viewer shows the requirement with no backlog links.
PRIORITY	wont
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-30 (owner request 199)

SECTION 7

Wireframes

FINAL 97/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Each sketch shows what a person sees and what they can do there, with the set's own content. None of them decides how anything looks or how it is built. Every screen has a tree of the PRD set on the left. The person expands the PRD, then a section, then an item.

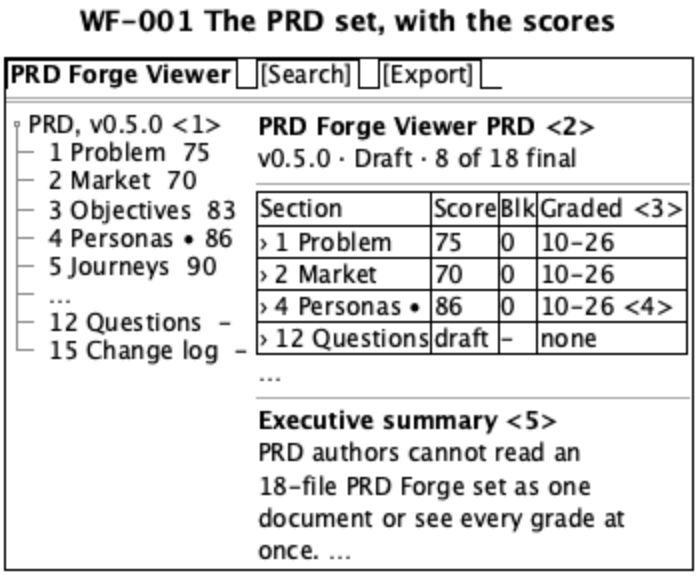
The PRD owner approved WF-001 to WF-009 on 2026-10-26. The sponsor approved the WF-006 change for FR-024 in version 0.3.2. Version 0.3.4 changes the example folder names in WF-006. Version 0.4.0 moves the list of PRD sets in docs/prd from WF-006 to WF-010, a state of WF-006. The sponsor approved both versions on 2026-10-27. Version 0.5.0 adds WF-011 for FR-025 (release 2), and the sketches show version 0.5.0. Version 0.7.0 adds WF-012 for FR-026 and FR-027, and WF-013 for FR-028, all in release 2.

The numbered marks in each sketch are explained, in order, by its `shows` list. Each sketch is also drawn in PlantUML Salt for the printed PRD.

WF-001 The PRD set, with the scores

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-001, FR-002, FR-003, FR-004, FR-005, and FR-009. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

The author opens the set and sees every section and its grade in one place. Each section in the root page is a link.

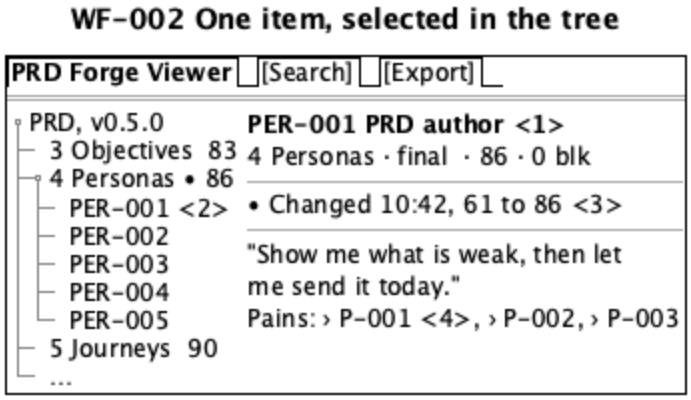


WF-001 drawing

WF-002 One item, selected in the tree

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-005, FR-007, FR-009, and FR-023. PER-001 sees it at ST-003.

The author expands a section and reads one item. The authoring tools changed the section a moment ago.



WF-002 drawing

WF-003 Search results

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-008 and FR-023. PER-002 sees it at ST-009.

The developer searches the requirements for "export". The search computes the relevance scores, so the numbers here only show the order: highest first.

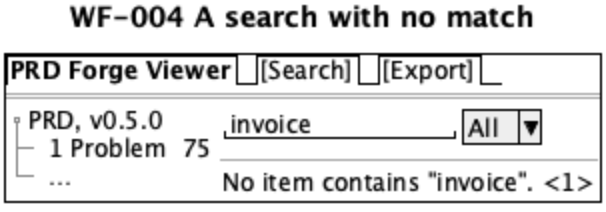


WF-003 drawing

WF-004 A search with no match

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-008. PER-002 sees it at ST-009.

SC-007 names this state.

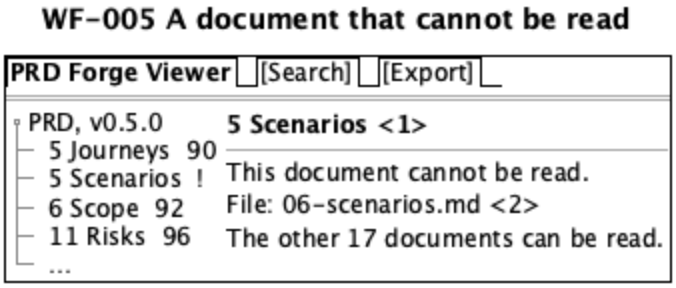


WF-004 drawing

WF-005 A document that cannot be read

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-003. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

SC-002 names this state.

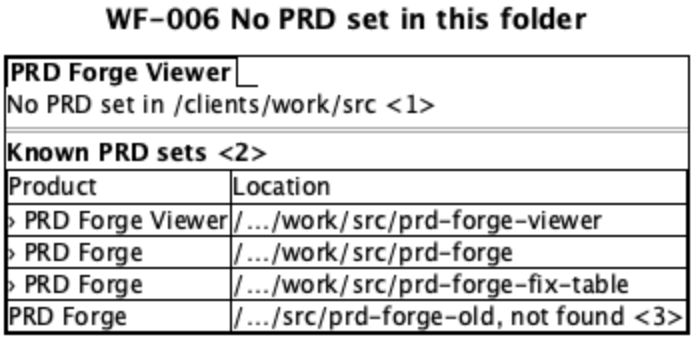


WF-005 drawing

WF-006 No PRD set in this folder

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-021 and FR-022. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

The author runs prdf in a folder with no PRD set. The first three locations are real PRD sets on the owner's computer. The fourth shows a location that no longer exists. When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the screen changes to WF-010.

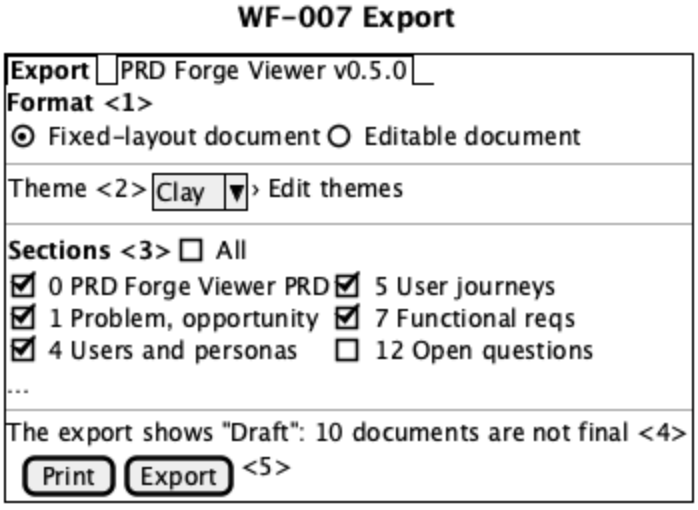


WF-006 drawing

WF-007 Export

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-010, FR-011, FR-012, FR-013, and FR-015. PER-001 sees it at ST-005.

The author exports the whole set, or some sections, in a theme.

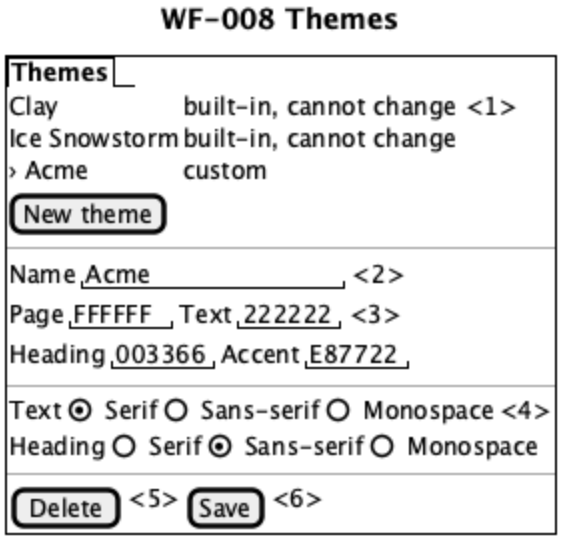


WF-007 drawing

WF-008 Themes

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-015, FR-016, FR-017, FR-018, and FR-020. PER-001 sees it at ST-005.

The author makes and changes the custom theme "Acme", the same theme that the acceptance criteria of FR-016 to FR-018 use. Its colors are the values the author types.

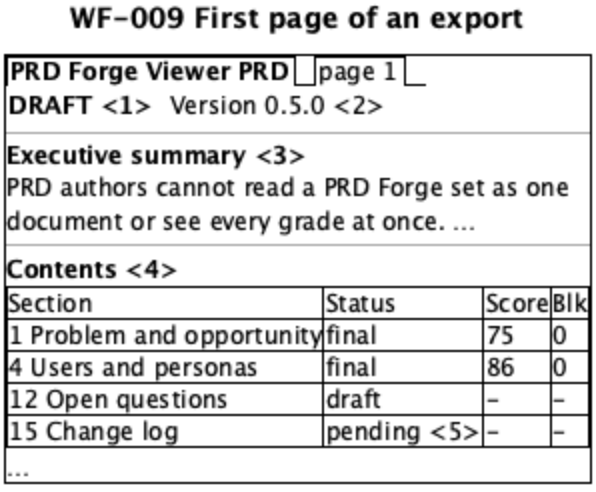


WF-008 drawing

WF-009 First page of an export

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-014, FR-019, and FR-010. PER-004 sees it at ST-011.

The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools and reads the first page. The contents rows are example values. No section of this set is pending today. The Change log row shows how a pending section looks (SC-004, FR-019).



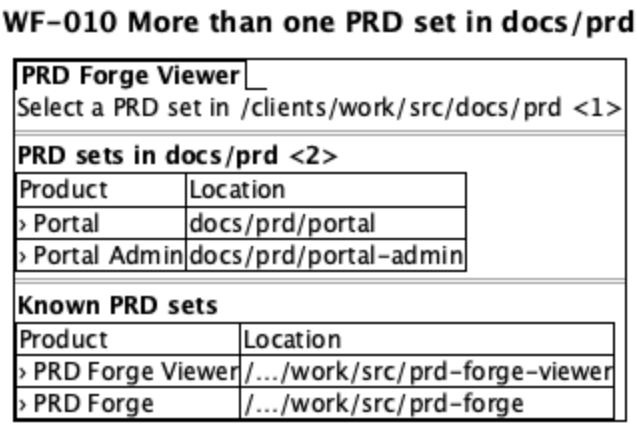
WF-009 drawing

WF-010 More than one PRD set in docs/prd

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-024 and FR-022. PER-001 sees it at ST-001. It is a state of WF-006.

The author runs prdf in a folder whose docs/prd holds two PRD sets, and neither set was open in the last session. The viewer lists the two sets above the known locations and opens neither until the author selects one. The product names

and folders are examples.

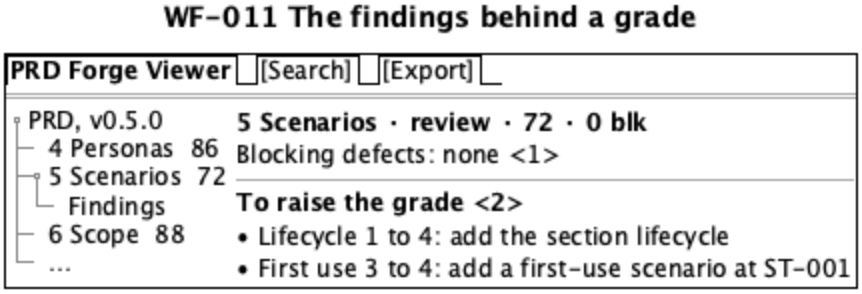


WF-010 drawing

WF-011 The findings behind a grade

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-025. PER-001 sees it at ST-002. FR-025 is in release 2.

The author reads the findings of section 5. The values come from the grade of section 5 on 2026-10-27.

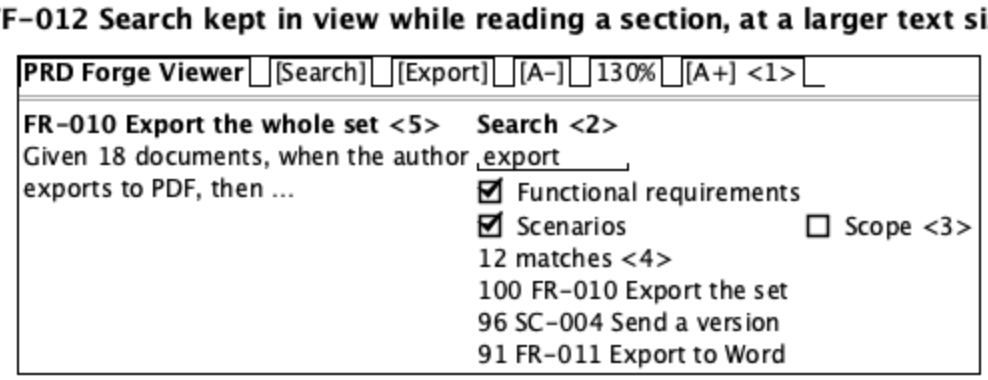


WF-011 drawing

WF-012 Search kept in view while reading a section, at a larger text size

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-008, FR-026, and FR-027. PER-002 sees it at ST-003. FR-026 and FR-027 are in release 2.

The developer searches two categories for "export", keeps search in view, and opens one result after another at a larger text size.

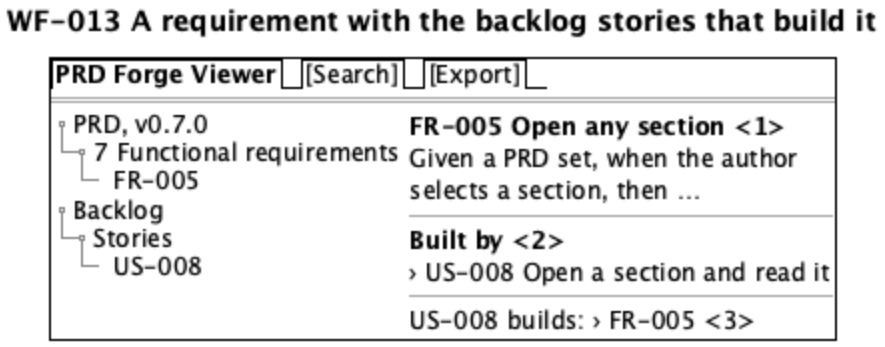


WF-012 drawing

WF-013 A requirement with the backlog stories that build it

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-028. PER-002 sees it at ST-003. FR-028 is in release 2.

The developer opens FR-005 and sees the backlog story that builds it, then opens the story and goes back to the requirement.



WF-013 drawing

WF-001 · The PRD set, with the scores

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-001 • FR-002 • FR-003 • FR-004 • FR-005 • FR-009
SHOWS	• The tree: the PRD, and below it every section with its score • The root page: the product name, the version, the draft mark, and the totals • The grades: each section is a link, with its score and blocking defects • The change mark on a section that changed • The executive summary

WF-002 · One item, selected in the tree

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-005 • FR-007 • FR-009 • FR-023
SHOWS	• The selected item, with the status and grade of its section • The selected item in the expanded section • The change notice • A reference that opens the item it names

WF-003 · Search results

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-002
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-009
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-008 • FR-023
SHOWS	• The search term and the category • The number of matches • The tree opens the section of the selected result • Each result: relevance score, ID, title, and section

WF-004 · A search with no match

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-002
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-009
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-008
SHOWS	• The no-match message

WF-005 · A document that cannot be read

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-003
SHOWS	• The tree and the page both mark the document that cannot be read • The file name of that document

WF-006 · No PRD set in this folder

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-021 • FR-022
SHOWS	• The folder where prdf ran • The known locations, each with its product name • A location whose PRD set no longer exists

WF-007 · Export

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-001

JOURNEY STAGE ST-005

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-012
- FR-013
- FR-015

SHOWS

- The format, from IN-006
- The theme; Edit themes opens WF-008
- The sections to export, in reading order
- The reason that the export shows Draft (TR-005)
- The print and export buttons

WF-008 · Themes

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-001

JOURNEY STAGE ST-005

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-020

SHOWS

- The themes; the two built-in themes cannot change
- The name of the custom theme
- The four colors
- The text font and the heading font
- The delete button, for a custom theme only
- The save button; a saved theme is still there after a restart

WF-009 · First page of an export

TYPE report

PERSONA PER-004

JOURNEY STAGE ST-011

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-014
- FR-019
- FR-010

SHOWS

- The draft mark
- The version
- The executive summary
- The contents, with the status, score, and blocking defects of each section
- A section that is not written yet, marked pending

WF-010 · More than one PRD set in docs/prd

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
STATE OF	WF-006
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-024 • FR-022
SHOWS	• The folder where prdf ran, and that the viewer opens no set until the author selects one • The PRD sets found in docs/prd, each with its product name and folder, above the known locations

WF-011 · The findings behind a grade

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-002
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-025
SHOWS	• The blocking defects of the section, or that it has none • The items to raise the grade, each with its dimension

WF-012 · Search kept in view while reading a section, at a larger text size

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-002
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-008 • FR-026 • FR-027
SHOWS	• The text size, with a step down, the size, and a step up • Search, kept in view beside the section • The categories, two of them selected • The results, which stay while the developer opens them • The item that the developer opened from a result

WF-013 · A requirement with the backlog stories that build it

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-002
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-028
SHOWS	• The requirement, with its fields • The stories in the backlog that build it, each one a link • A story, with a link back to its requirements

SECTION 8

Non-functional requirements

FINAL 82/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The PRD owner accepted these targets on 2026-10-26, and extended NFR-008 on 2026-10-28. The test computer is the one in OUT-003. Each speed target holds for a PRD set of at most 18 documents and 176 KB of text, the size of this set on 2026-10-28.

The speed targets follow the response time limits of Jakob Nielsen. 1.0 second is the limit for an uninterrupted flow of thought, so search (NFR-003) has 0.5 seconds. 10 seconds is the limit of attention, so the export (NFR-004) has 10 seconds. The author opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD (Q-003), so the open and update targets are 2 seconds.

ID	CATEGORY	REQUIREMENT	TARGET
NFR-001	performance	Open a PRD set, also with prdf and from the list of sets	p95 at most 2 s
NFR-002	performance	Show a change from the authoring tools	p95 at most 2 s
NFR-003	performance	Show search results	p95 at most 0.5 s
NFR-004	performance	Make an export of the whole set	p95 at most 10 s
NFR-005	privacy	No PRD content leaves the computer	zero network transfers
NFR-006	availability	Every feature works offline	100% of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006
NFR-007	accessibility	Keyboard-only use, WCAG 2.2 AA through WCAG2ICT	100%, zero failures
NFR-008	durability	Custom themes, known locations, and the last set survive a restart	zero lost
NFR-009	accessibility	Exports work with a screen reader	zero checker errors
NFR-010	security	Only local content shows. No script runs, nothing remote loads	zero scripts, zero requests

NFR-002. Show a change from the authoring tools

This sets the time limit that FR-009 and SC-003 refer to.

NFR-005. No PRD content leaves the computer

The viewer never sends PRD content over a network. The test counts every transfer, because a search of encrypted traffic cannot find PRD text.

NFR-007. Keyboard use and WCAG

WCAG 2.2 is written for web content. WCAG2ICT, a W3C Group Note, says how each success criterion applies to non-web software such as the viewer.

NFR-010. Only local content shows

A PRD set can hold a script or a link to a remote image. The viewer shows the text and the local files only. Each test script changes its section text to SCRIPT RAN if it runs, so a tester can see it.

Categories that do not apply

CATEGORY	REASON
Scale	One person opens one local PRD set of at most 18 documents at a time. NFR-001 to NFR-004 give the largest set size.
Retention	The viewer does not change a PRD set in release 1 (OUT-001). The PRD set stays where the authoring tools keep it. The viewer keeps only what it needs to search a set, and the author's settings.
Observability	The viewer runs on the person's own computer and loads nothing remote (NFR-010). Failures show to that person, as in FR-003.

Requirements

NFR-001 · The author sees a PRD set within 2 seconds of opening it.

CATEGORY
performance

METRIC
Time from the open action to the moment the author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and the status of every document.

TARGET
p95 at most 2 seconds, for a PRD set of at most 18 documents and 176 KB of text, the size of this set on 2026-10-28

MEASUREMENT
On one day, open this PRD set 20 times on the test computer (OUT-003): 10 times from the viewer, 5 times with prdf, and 5 times from the list of sets. Time each open from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.

PRIORITY
must

APPLIES TO
- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-021
- FR-024

SOURCE
PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The author opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD (Q-003). 2 seconds is within the 10-second limit of attention in "Response Times: The 3 Important Limits", Jakob Nielsen, Nielsen Norman Group, 1993, updated 2014, https://www.nngroup.com/articles/response-times-3-important-limits/

NFR-002 · The author sees a change from the authoring tools within 2 seconds of the save.

CATEGORY
performance

METRIC
Time from the moment the authoring tools save a section to the moment the author sees the new text and score in the viewer.

TARGET
p95 at most 2 seconds, for a PRD set of at most 18 documents and 176 KB of text, the size of this set on 2026-10-28

MEASUREMENT
On one day, change and save one section 20 times while the viewer shows it, on the test computer. Time each update from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.

PRIORITY
must

APPLIES TO
- FR-009

SOURCE
PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The author checks each change while writing (Q-003, SC-003).

NFR-003 · The developer sees search results within 0.5 seconds of searching.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the search action to the moment the developer sees the results.
TARGET	p95 at most 0.5 seconds, for a PRD set of at most 18 documents and 176 KB of text, the size of this set on 2026-10-28
MEASUREMENT	On one day, run 20 searches with different terms and categories on this PRD set, on the test computer. Time each from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-008
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. A search must not break the developer's flow of thought. Nielsen gives 1.0 second as the limit for an uninterrupted flow of thought, and 0.5 seconds keeps half of that as a margin. "Response Times: The 3 Important Limits", Jakob Nielsen, Nielsen Norman Group, 1993, updated 2014, https://www.nngroup.com/articles/response-times-3-important-limits/

NFR-004 · The author has the export file within 10 seconds of starting the export.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the export action to the moment the file is ready to open.
TARGET	p95 at most 10 seconds, for the whole PRD set, at most 18 documents and 176 KB of text, the size of this set on 2026-10-28
MEASUREMENT	On one day, export this PRD set 20 times, 10 times in each format of IN-006, on the test computer. Time each export, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The author waits for the export and does not change to another task. Nielsen gives 10 seconds as the limit for keeping the user's attention. "Response Times: The 3 Important Limits", Jakob Nielsen, Nielsen Norman Group, 1993, updated 2014, https://www.nngroup.com/articles/response-times-3-important-limits/

NFR-005 · No content of a PRD set leaves the author's computer.

CATEGORY	privacy
METRIC	Number of network transfers that the viewer makes during a session. A transfer counts even if its content is encrypted.
TARGET	Zero
MEASUREMENT	On one day, record all network connections that the viewer opens on the test computer during a session that opens, searches, and exports this PRD set. Count every connection to a host other than the computer itself. The count is zero.
PRIORITY	must
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. A PRD set can hold client information, because the sponsor (PER-004) is a client executive. No feature needs to send it (NFR-010).

NFR-006 · Every release 1 feature works without a network connection.

CATEGORY	availability
METRIC	Share of the release 1 functional requirements that pass with the network off.
TARGET	100% of the 23 functional requirements
MEASUREMENT	On one day, turn off all network connections on the test computer and run the acceptance criteria of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006.
PRIORITY	must
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The viewer shows only local content (NFR-010), so no feature needs a network.

NFR-007 · A person who uses only a keyboard can do every task in the viewer.

CATEGORY	accessibility
METRIC	Share of the release 1 acceptance criteria that a tester completes with a keyboard only, and the count of failures of the WCAG 2.2 level AA success criteria, as WCAG2ICT applies them to non-web software.
TARGET	100% of the acceptance criteria, and zero level AA failures
MEASUREMENT	In one week, a tester runs the acceptance criteria of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006, with a keyboard only. The tester then checks the viewer against each WCAG 2.2 level AA success criterion that WCAG2ICT applies to non-web software.
PRIORITY	must
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The success criteria come from WCAG 2.2, applied to a desktop app by "Guidance on Applying WCAG 2 to Non-Web Information and Communications Technologies (WCAG2ICT)", W3C Group Note, 11 December 2025, https://www.w3.org/TR/wcag2ict-22/

NFR-008

STATEMENT	Custom export themes, the known locations, and the last open PRD set are not lost when the viewer restarts.
CATEGORY	durability
METRIC	Number of custom themes, theme values, known locations, or last-set records lost after a restart.
TARGET	Zero
MEASUREMENT	On one day, make 5 custom themes, open PRD sets from 3 locations, and leave one set open. Close the viewer, restart the computer, and open the viewer. Compare every theme value and every known location, and check that the same set is open.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-002 • FR-016 • FR-020 • FR-022
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26, extended on 2026-10-28 to the known locations and the last set. The author makes these once and expects to find them again.

NFR-009 · A reader who uses a screen reader can read every export.

CATEGORY	accessibility
METRIC	Number of errors that the accessibility checker of a reader for each format of IN-006 reports on an export.
TARGET	Zero errors, for each format of IN-006
MEASUREMENT	On one day, export this PRD set in each format of IN-006. Run the accessibility checker of a reader for that format on each file.
PRIORITY	should
APPLIES TO	• FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. Every reader of the export (PER-003, PER-004, PER-005) must be able to read it, also a reader who uses a screen reader.

NFR-010

STATEMENT	The viewer shows content only from files on the computer. No script in a PRD set runs, and no remote image or link loads.
CATEGORY	security
METRIC	Number of scripts that run, and number of network requests that the viewer makes, while it shows a test PRD set that holds a script in a section, a script in a diagram, a remote image, and a remote link.
TARGET	Zero scripts run and zero network requests
MEASUREMENT	On one day, on the test computer, start a network monitor and open the test PRD set. Each test script, if it runs, changes the visible text of its section to SCRIPT RAN. Read every section, select the remote link, and count the sections that show SCRIPT RAN and the network requests.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-001 • FR-005 • FR-007 • FR-008 • FR-009 • FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012 • FR-013 • FR-023
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. A PRD set can come from another person, and its content must not act on the author's computer.

Not applicable

scale

REASON	One person opens one local PRD set at a time, and a set has at most 18 documents. NFR-001 to NFR-004 give the largest set size. The viewer has no shared data and no other users.

retention

REASON

The viewer does not change a PRD set in release 1 (OUT-001). The PRD set stays where the authoring tools keep it. The viewer keeps only what it needs to search a set, and the author's settings.

observability

REASON

The viewer runs on the person's own computer and loads nothing remote (NFR-010). Failures show to that person, as in FR-003. No service exists to monitor.

SECTION 9

Constraints

FINAL 85/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Constraints are rules that the product team cannot change by agreement. C-003 comes from the published PRD Forge format. The viewer must read the PRD sets that the authoring tools already write, so the team cannot change the format.

ID	CATEGORY	RULE	AUTHORITY
C-003	standard	The viewer reads the PRD Forge document format, version 1	The prd-forge/*@1 schemas

C-003. The PRD Forge document format

The viewer reads PRD sets that follow the PRD Forge version 1 layout and headers.

Retired constraints

C-001 (the export formats), C-002 (the viewer is read-only), and C-004 (release 1 runs on macOS only) were retired in version 0.6.0. Each is a release 1 decision that the PRD owner can change, not an outside rule. Section 6 records them: IN-006 names the export formats, OUT-001 records the read-only rule, and OUT-003 records macOS only. The PRD owner revisits OUT-001 and OUT-003 at the release 2 review on 2026-11-06. The ids C-001, C-002, and C-004 are not used again.

C-003

STATEMENT: The viewer reads PRD sets in the document layout of the authoring tools, version 1: one root document and the section documents, with the headers and links that the prd-forge/*@1 schemas define.

CATEGORY: standard

AUTHORITY: The PRD Forge document format, version 1: the prd-forge/*@1 schemas in the schemas folder of https://github.com/SpillwaveSolutions/prd-forge. Release 0.9.0 of the authoring tools, read on 2026-10-28, uses them for 18 documents.

APPLIES TO:

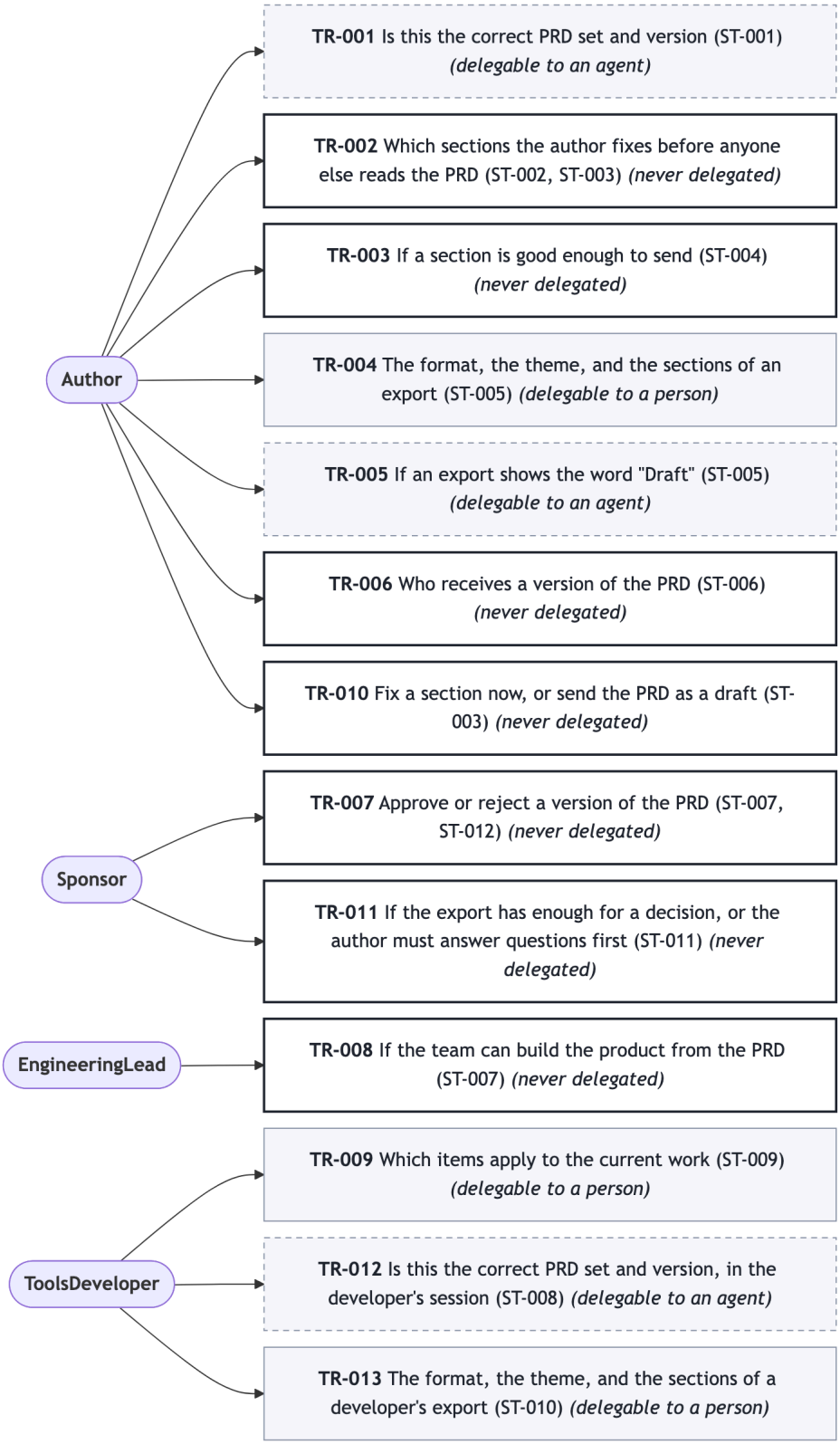
- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-004
- FR-005
- FR-007
- FR-008
- FR-009
- FR-023
- FR-024

VERIFICATION: Open a PRD set that passes the validator of the authoring tools, release 0.9.0. Every document and every grade shows in the viewer. Then change one section header so that it fails the schema, and open the set again. That section shows as unreadable, as FR-003 says.

SECTION 10

Decision rights

FINAL 88/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



Who decides what

A person makes every decision in the journeys, with two exceptions. The viewer proposes the PRD set from the last session (TR-001, TR-012), and the viewer decides if an export shows "Draft" by a fixed rule (TR-005).

"Software may decide: No" and "Always a person: No" together mean that a person decides, but the viewer can offer a default, such as the last theme used.

- PER-004 approves a version. PER-001, PER-002, PER-003, and PER-005 may not.
- PER-001 decides what goes to whom. The viewer may not send anything.
- No person may remove the "Draft" mark in the viewer.

ID	DECISION	APPROVER	SOFTWARE MAY DECIDE	ALWAYS A PERSON
TR-001	Is this the correct PRD set and version	PER-001	Yes, it proposes the last set	No
TR-002	Which sections to fix first	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-003	If a section is good enough to send	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-004	Format, theme, and sections of an export	PER-001	No	No
TR-005	If an export shows "Draft"	PER-001, through section status	Yes	No
TR-006	Who receives a version	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-007	Approve or reject a version	PER-004	No	Yes
TR-008	If the team can build from the PRD	PER-003	No	Yes
TR-009	Which items apply to the current work	PER-002	No	No
TR-010	Fix a section now, or send as a draft	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-011	Enough to decide, or ask the author first	PER-004	No	Yes
TR-012	Is this the correct PRD set, in the developer's session	PER-002	Yes, it proposes the last set	No
TR-013	Format, theme, and sections of a developer's export	PER-002	No	No

TR-005. The "Draft" rule

An export shows "Draft" when any document in the PRD set is not at final. The author cannot remove the mark in the viewer. To remove it, the author takes every section to final in the authoring tools. The PRD owner decided this rule on

2026-10-26.

TR-007. approval

Only the sponsor approves a version. The export never says that a PRD is approved. The author records the approval in section 15. The escalation when the sponsor is not available: the approval waits, and nobody else approves (Q-006). When the sponsor rejects a version, the author records the rejection and its reason in section 15, fixes the PRD, and sends a new version.

TR-001 · Is this the correct PRD set and version (ST-001)

STAGES	• ST-001
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	yes
NEVER DELEGATED	no
AGENT ROLE	proposes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The product name and version of the PRD set that is open.
ESCALATION	The viewer proposes the PRD set from the last session. Nobody else decides. The author opens a different PRD set at any time.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author closed the viewer with a PRD set open, when the author opens the viewer again, then the same PRD set is open and the author sees its product name and version. • Given the same PRD set reopened, when the author opens a different PRD set, then the different PRD set is open.

TR-002 · Which sections the author fixes before anyone else reads the PRD (ST-002, ST-003)

STAGES	• ST-002 • ST-003
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section, in one view.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given sections with different scores, when the author views the grades, then the viewer shows every section and does not mark any section as "to fix" on its own.

TR-003 · If a section is good enough to send (ST-004)

STAGES	• ST-004
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The new score, count of blocking defects, and status of the changed section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a section that the authoring tools changed, when the author views it, then the author sees its new score, count of blocking defects, and status before choosing to export.

TR-004 · The format, the theme, and the sections of an export (ST-005)

STAGES	• ST-005
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The selected format, theme, and sections before the export starts.
ESCALATION	The export waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author starts an export, when the author has not selected a format, then the author has no file. • Given the author starts an export, when the author has not selected any section, then the author has no file. • Given the author selects a format, a theme, and sections, when the export finishes, then the author sees the selected format, theme, and sections in the file.

TR-005 · If an export shows the word "Draft" (ST-005)

STAGES	• ST-005
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	yes
NEVER DELEGATED	no
AGENT ROLE	acts
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status of every section in the PRD set at the time of export.
ESCALATION	PER-001 decides through the status of each section in the authoring tools. The viewer applies the rule, and no person can change the mark in the viewer. If the author thinks that the mark is wrong, the author changes the status of the sections in the authoring tools and exports again.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the root document and 15 sections at final and 1 section at review, when the author exports, then the first page shows "Draft". • Given all 17 section documents and the root document at final, when the author exports, then the export does not show "Draft". • Given an export that shows "Draft", when the author tries to remove the mark in the viewer, then the mark stays.

TR-006 · Who receives a version of the PRD (ST-006)

STAGES	• ST-006
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The version and the draft mark of the export.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author makes an export, when the export finishes, then the viewer has sent the file to nobody.

TR-007 · Approve or reject a version of the PRD (ST-007, ST-012)

STAGES	• ST-007 • ST-012
APPROVER	PER-004
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The export, with the version, the draft mark, and the status and score of every section.
ESCALATION	When the sponsor is not available, the approval waits. Nobody else approves (Q-006). When the sponsor rejects a version, the author records the rejection and its reason in the change log in section 15, fixes the PRD, and sends a new version.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given any export, when the sponsor opens it, then the export does not say that the PRD is approved. The author records the approval in the change log in section 15.

TR-008 · If the team can build the product from the PRD (ST-007)

STAGES	• ST-007
APPROVER	PER-003
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The export, with every section and the status and score of each.
ESCALATION	The engineering lead sends comments to the author, who fixes the PRD in the authoring tools. If the engineering lead is not available, the decision waits.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an export of the whole PRD set, when the engineering lead opens it, then every section is in the file, with its status and score.

TR-009 · Which items apply to the current work (ST-009)

STAGES	• ST-009
APPROVER	PER-002
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The matching items, each with its id and section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the developer. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a search with matches, when the developer views the results, then the viewer selects no item on its own.

TR-010 · Fix a section now, or send the PRD as a draft (ST-003)

STAGES	• ST-003
APPROVER	PER-001
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status, score, and count of blocking defects of the section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a section with 1 blocking defect, when the author exports, then the viewer makes the export and shows "Draft", and does not stop the export.

TR-011

DECISION	If the export has enough for a decision, or the author must answer questions first (ST-011)
STAGES	• ST-011
APPROVER	PER-004
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The version, the draft mark, the executive summary, and the status and score of every section.
ESCALATION	The sponsor asks the author. The approval waits (Q-006).
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an export of the whole PRD set, when the sponsor opens it, then the first two pages show the version, the draft mark, the executive summary, and the contents list with the status and score of every section.

TR-012 · Is this the correct PRD set and version, in the developer's session (ST-008)

STAGES	• ST-008
APPROVER	PER-002
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	yes
NEVER DELEGATED	no
AGENT ROLE	proposes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The product name and version of the PRD set that is open.
ESCALATION	The viewer proposes the PRD set from the last session. Nobody else decides. The developer opens a different PRD set at any time.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the developer closed the viewer with a PRD set open, when the developer opens the viewer again, then the same PRD set is open and the developer sees its product name and version. • Given the same PRD set reopened, when the developer opens a different PRD set, then the different PRD set is open.

TR-013 · The format, the theme, and the sections of a developer's export (ST-010)

STAGES	• ST-010
APPROVER	PER-002
DELEGABLE TO AN AGENT	no
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The selected format, theme, and sections before the export starts.
ESCALATION	The export waits for the developer. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the developer starts an export, when the developer has not selected any section, then the developer has no file. • Given the developer selects a format and two sections, when the export finishes, then the developer sees the selected format and only those two sections in the file.

SECTION 11

Assumptions, risks, and dependencies

REVIEW 96/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Release 1 target date: 2026-11-06, set by the PRD owner on 2026-10-28. Release 2 target date: 2026-11-06, set on 2026-10-26.

ID	ASSUMPTION	IF IT IS FALSE
A-001	Stakeholders open PDF and Word without installing anything	IN-006, FR-010, and FR-011 change
A-002	The PRD set is on the same computer as the viewer	FR-001, FR-002, NFR-005, and NFR-006 change
A-003	The PRD Forge version 1 format is stable until release 1	C-003, FR-001, FR-003, and FR-004 can fail
A-004	Authors want a viewer, not only the command-line export	O-001 does not move

ID	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	OWNER
R-001	A PRD Forge format change breaks the viewer	medium	high	Richard Hightower
R-002	Few teams use PRD Forge	medium	medium	Richard Hightower
R-003	Nobody measures the O-001 baseline	medium	medium	Richard Hightower

ID	NEED	FROM	BY	STATUS	BLOCKS
D-001	Stable PRD Forge version 1 format	PRD Forge	2026-10-26	committed	C-003, FR-001, FR-003, FR-004
D-002	PRD Forge records grade findings	PRD Forge	2026-10-26	delivered	OUT-002

D-002 was delivered in PRD Forge 0.2.0, which writes the reasons for each grade beside each section.

Assumptions

> **A-001 · Stakeholders open PDF and Word files without installing anything.**
>
> IF FALSE — IN-006 changes, and FR-010 and FR-011 need other formats.
>
> VALIDATED BY — Send the first export of this PRD to PER-003 and PER-004 and ask.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

> **A-002 · The PRD set is on the same computer as the viewer.**
>
> IF FALSE — FR-001 and FR-002 change, and NFR-005 and NFR-006 need new targets.
>
> VALIDATED BY — Ask the first three authors where they keep their PRD sets.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

> **A-003 · The PRD Forge version 1 format stays the same until release 1 ships.**
>
> IF FALSE — C-003 changes, and FR-001, FR-003, and FR-004 can fail on new files (R-001).
>
> VALIDATED BY — D-001.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

A-004 · Authors want a viewer, and the current command-line export is not enough for them.

IF FALSE	O-001 does not move because of the viewer, and P-001 and P-002 need a different answer.
VALIDATED BY	Measure O-001 on this PRD with and without the viewer (Q-001).
OWNER	Richard Hightower

Risks

R-001 · A change to the PRD Forge document format breaks the viewer.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	high
MITIGATION	C-003 fixes the format at version 1. FR-003 shows each unreadable document by name. D-001 keeps the format stable for release 1.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

R-002 · Few teams use PRD Forge, so the viewer has few users.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	medium
MITIGATION	Measure O-001 on this PRD first, and report it by 2027-03-31.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

R-003 · Nobody measures the baseline for O-001, so nobody can show success.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	medium
MITIGATION	Q-001, due 2026-11-30.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

Dependencies

D-001 · PRD Forge keeps the version 1 document format stable until release 1 ships.

FROM	PRD Forge maintainers, owned by Richard Hightower
BY	2026-10-26
STATUS	committed
BLOCKS	• C-003 • FR-001 • FR-003 • FR-004

D-002 · PRD Forge records the findings behind each grade in the PRD set.

FROM	PRD Forge maintainers, owned by Richard Hightower
BY	2026-10-26
STATUS	delivered
BLOCKS	• OUT-002

SECTION 12

Open questions

DRAFT

Questions are collected during the interview and consolidated later.

ID	QUESTION	DECIDER	BY
Q-001	How long from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback today? Answered: about 10 days on the historic PRDs.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-002	How many stakeholders review a PRD, and how many have the tools? Answered: two have the tools, the others read the export or review through a proxy.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-003	How often do PER-001 and PER-002 open a PRD in the viewer? Answered: the author, several times a day.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-004	Must release 1 show the findings behind each grade? Answered: no, later, after a change to the authoring tools.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-005	Is editing text in the viewer in release 1? Answered: no, it is a later feature.	Richard Hightower	2026-10-26
Q-006	Who approves when the sponsor is not available? Answered: nobody, the approval waits.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-007	When must PRD Forge record grade findings? Answered: PRD Forge 0.2.0 does it now.	Richard Hightower	2026-10-26
Q-008	What other unhappy path does J-002 need? Answered: an export with a pending section (SC-008).	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-009	How often, and for how long, does a review start with a search for an item? Answered: about 10 searches of about 3 minutes.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30

Q-001. Time from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback

Measure it on this PRD as the baseline. Blocks the cost of inaction for P-001 and P-002.

Answered on 2026-10-28: the historic PRDs took about 10 calendar days. This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool.

Q-002. Stakeholders per PRD, and how many have the tools

Answered on 2026-11-01: two of the stakeholders who review a typical PRD have Claude Code and PRD Forge. The other stakeholders read the export, or a stakeholder with the tools reviews for them as a proxy. The export stays the main way to reach most reviewers (P-002).

Q-003. How often PER-001 and PER-002 open a PRD in the viewer

Answered on 2026-10-26: the author opens the viewer several times a day.

Q-004. The findings behind each grade

Answered on 2026-10-26: the findings are a later feature. The feature depends on a change to the authoring tools so that they record the findings in the PRD set. Release 1 shows the status, score, blocking count, and grade date.

Q-005. Editing text in the viewer

Answered on 2026-10-26: editing is a later feature, not in release 1. The author changes sections only in the authoring tools. Section 6 records it as a non-goal for release 1.

Q-006. Approval when the sponsor is not available

Answered on 2026-10-26: the approval waits until the sponsor is available.

Q-007. Date for the grade findings

Answered on 2026-10-26: PRD Forge 0.2.0 records the findings now (D-002 delivered).

Q-008. A second unhappy path for J-002

J-002 has one happy scenario (SC-005) and one exception (SC-007), a search with no match. The PRD owner decides by 2026-11-30 if release 1 needs another one.

Answered on 2026-10-27: a developer exports a section that is still pending (SC-008). Release 1 handles it as a should.

Q-009. Time to find an item

P-001 had no measured cost. The PRD owner counts the searches for an item in one review of this PRD, and the minutes of each, by 2026-11-30.

Answered on 2026-10-28: about 10 searches in one review, about 3 minutes each (owner estimate). P-001 records the cost, about 30 minutes for each review.

> **Q-001**
>
> | | |
> |---|---|
> | QUESTION | How long does it take today from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback? The PRD owner estimates about 10 days. Measure it on this PRD to replace the estimate. |
> | DECIDER | Richard Hightower |
> | BY | 2026-11-30 |
> | ANSWER | The historic PRDs took about 10 calendar days. This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool. The 10 days stay the baseline of O-001. |
> | ANSWERED | 2026-10-28 |
> | BLOCKS | • P-001
• P-002 |

Q-002

QUESTION How many stakeholders review a typical PRD, and how many of them have Claude Code and PRD Forge?

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-11-30

ANSWER Two of the stakeholders who review a typical PRD have Claude Code and PRD Forge. The other stakeholders read the export, or a stakeholder with the tools reviews for them as a proxy.

ANSWERED 2026-11-01

BLOCKS

- P-002

Q-003

QUESTION How often do the PRD author (PER-001) and the developer who uses PRD Forge (PER-002) open a PRD in the viewer?

ANSWERED 2026-10-26

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-11-30

BLOCKS

- PER-001
- PER-002

ANSWER Answered on 2026-10-26. The author opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD. The frequency for PER-002 is not known.

Q-004

QUESTION The findings behind each grade (what is missing and what to improve) are not kept in the PRD set today. Must release 1 show them, and if so, who records them so that the author can see them later?

ANSWERED 2026-10-26

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-11-30

BLOCKS

- ST-002
- ST-003
- P-003

ANSWER Answered on 2026-10-26. Release 1 does not show the findings behind each grade. That is a later feature, and it depends on a change to the authoring tools so that they record the findings in the PRD set. Release 1 shows the status, score, blocking count, and grade date that the authoring tools already record.

Q-005 · Is editing text in the viewer in release 1?

ANSWERED 2026-10-26

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-10-26

ANSWER No. Editing in the viewer is a later feature. In release 1 the author changes sections only in the authoring tools. Section 6 records this as a non-goal for release 1.

Q-006

QUESTION When the sponsor (PER-004) is not available to approve a version, who approves it, or does the approval wait?

ANSWERED 2026-10-26

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-11-30

BLOCKS
- TR-007

ANSWER Answered on 2026-10-26. The approval waits until the sponsor is available. Nobody else approves.

Q-007

QUESTION By what date must PRD Forge record the findings behind each grade (D-002), and in which release does the viewer show them (OUT-002)?

ANSWERED 2026-10-26

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-10-26

BLOCKS
- D-002
- OUT-002

ANSWER Answered on 2026-10-26. PRD Forge 0.2.0 already writes the reasons for each grade to a grades file beside each section, so D-002 is delivered. The PRD owner decides when the viewer shows them.

Q-008

QUESTION J-002 has one happy scenario (SC-005) and one exception (SC-007). What other way can a developer's search or export of selected sections go wrong, and must release 1 handle it?

DECIDER Richard Hightower

BY 2026-11-30

ANSWER A developer exports a section that is still pending. The export has every selected section, and the pending one says that it is not written yet (SC-008). Release 1 handles it as a should.

ANSWERED 2026-10-27

BLOCKS
- J-002

Q-009

QUESTION In one review of this PRD, how many times does the author or a developer search for an item before the discussion can start, and how many minutes does each search take? Measure it to give P-001 its evidence and cost.

ANSWERED 2026-10-28

DECIDER Richard Hightower

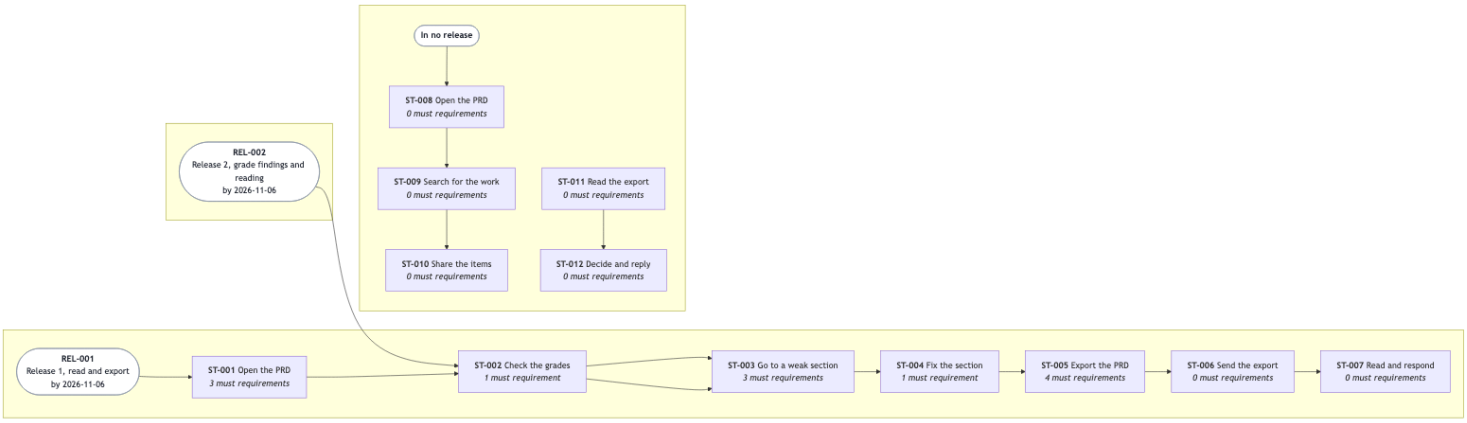
BY 2026-11-30

ANSWER About 10 searches in one review of this PRD, about 3 minutes each, so about 30 minutes for each review (PRD owner estimate, 2026-10-28). P-001 records it.

SECTION 13

Release plan

REVIEW 96/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



The release line

ID	RELEASE	TARGET DATE	STAGES	REQUIREMENTS
REL-001	Release 1, read and export	2026-11-06, committed	ST-001 to ST-007	FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006
REL-002	Release 2, grade findings and reading	2026-11-06, indicative	ST-002, ST-003	FR-025 to FR-028

REL-001. Release 1, read and export

The author reads the whole PRD set, sees the grades, and sends a themed PDF or Word export with a draft mark. A developer searches and exports selected sections, as part of ST-003 and ST-005. Release 1 comes first because it delivers the golden thread J-001. The PRD owner commits the date to the product sponsor (PER-004). ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer. Release 1 is done when SC-001 passes and every must requirement passes its acceptance criteria. The PRD owner moved the target date from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-27 on 2026-10-26, and to 2026-11-06 on 2026-10-28. Release 1 runs on macOS only (OUT-003).

REL-002. Release 2, grade findings and reading

The author sees the findings behind each grade (FR-025). The author and the developers also read at a larger or smaller text size (FR-026), keep search results in view (FR-027), and move between requirements and the backlog stories that build them (FR-028). Release 2 comes second because release 1 is the golden thread J-001, and findings are useful only after the author sees all grades in one view (FR-004, release 1). Findings serve O-002. The authoring tools already record them (D-002). Editing in the viewer (OUT-001) has no release yet.

REL-001 · Release 1, read and export

OUTCOMES

- The author opens a PRD set, sees the grade of every section in one view, goes to any section, and sees changes from the authoring tools without any action.
- The author sends stakeholders a PDF or Word export, in a theme the author selects, that shows the version and the draft mark.
- A developer searches the PRD set by term and category and exports selected sections.

JOURNEY STAGES

- ST-001
- ST-002
- ST-003
- ST-004
- ST-005
- ST-006
- ST-007

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-004
- FR-005
- FR-007
- FR-008
- FR-009
- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-012
- FR-013
- FR-014
- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-019
- FR-020
- FR-021
- FR-022
- FR-023
- FR-024

OBJECTIVES

- O-001

TARGET DATE

2026-11-06

DATE STATUS

committed

EXIT CRITERIA

- SC-001, the end-to-end acceptance test for release 1, passes.
- Every must requirement in this release passes its acceptance criteria.

REL-002 · Release 2, grade findings and reading

OUTCOMES

- The author sees, for each section, the findings behind its grade: what is missing and what to improve.
- The author and the developers read at a text size that suits them, keep search results in view, and move between requirements and the backlog stories that build them.

JOURNEY STAGES

- ST-002
- ST-003

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-025
- FR-026
- FR-027
- FR-028

OBJECTIVES

- O-001
- O-002

TARGET DATE

2026-11-06

DATE STATUS

indicative

DEPENDS ON

- D-002

EXIT CRITERIA

- For each graded section, the author sees the findings behind its grade: what is missing and what to improve.
- The author changes the text size from 80% to 200% in steps, and the next session opens at the size the author picked.
- The developer opens three search results one after another without searching again.
- When a backlog made from the PRD set is next to it, each requirement that a story builds shows that story, and the story links back to the requirement.

SECTION 14

Glossary

DRAFT

Each term enters the glossary when it first appears in the interview.

TERM	MEANING
PRD set	One PRD as 18 linked documents. The unit of work.
section	One of the 17 section documents in a PRD set.
authoring tools	The tools that write and grade the PRD set. Today: PRD Forge in Claude Code.
grade	A score from 0 to 100, a blocking-defect count, and a date.
blocking defect	A fault that stops a section from going to review or final.
status	pending, draft, review, or final.
golden thread	The one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end (J-001).
journey	The stages that one persona goes through to reach one goal.
stage	One large step of a journey.
persona	One role that uses the product or approves something about it.
export	A document file or printed copy that a reader opens without the authoring tools.
export theme	A named set of colors and fonts that controls how an export looks.
MoSCoW priority	must, should, could, or won't, for release 1. Source: Agile Business Consortium.
acceptance criterion	A Given, when, then test of one requirement. Source: Dan North, "Introducing BDD".
built-in theme	A theme that comes with the viewer: Ice Snowstorm or Clay.
fixed-layout document	An export whose pages look the same everywhere. Format in IN-006.
unreadable document	A document whose header the viewer cannot read. Pending is not unreadable.
contents list	The list of every document, in reading order, at the start of an export.
reading order	Root document first, then each section by its order number.
editable document	An export that a reader can change in a word processor. Format in IN-006.

PRD set

MEANING

One PRD as 18 linked documents: one root index with the executive summary, and 17 section documents. The unit of work for every persona.

SEE ALSO

- section
- authoring tools

section

MEANING — One of the 17 section documents in a PRD set, such as problem and opportunity, user journeys, or functional requirements.

authoring tools

MEANING — The tools that interview the author, write the PRD set, and grade each section. Today these are PRD Forge, used inside Claude Code. The viewer reads their output and does not replace them.

NOT — The viewer. The viewer reads and exports a PRD set; it does not write or grade it.

grade

MEANING — The result of checking one section against its rubric: a score from 0 to 100, a count of blocking defects, and the date of the check.

SEE ALSO
- blocking defect

blocking defect

MEANING — A fault in a section that stops it from going to review or final, whatever its score.

status

MEANING — The stage of a section or of the PRD set: pending (not interviewed), draft (written), review (with reviewers), or final (approved).

NOT — A review meeting. "Review" is a status.

golden thread

MEANING — The one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end. In this PRD it is J-001.

journey

MEANING — The stages that one persona goes through to reach one goal, from start to end, including steps outside the product.

SEE ALSO
- stage

stage

MEANING — One large step of a journey, with an actor, inputs, outputs, and a decision.

persona

MEANING — One role that uses the product or approves something about it.

export

MEANING — A copy of the whole PRD set or of selected sections, as one document file or as a printed copy, that a reader opens without the authoring tools.

SEE ALSO
- export theme

export theme

MEANING — A named set of colors and fonts that controls how an export looks. Some themes come with the viewer, and the author can make more.

MoSCoW priority

MEANING — The priority of a requirement: must (release 1 needs it), should (important, not essential for release 1), could (if time allows), or won't (not in this release).

NOT — A won't requirement is not a non-goal. It is out of release 1 and comes back in a later release, as FR-025 does in release 2. The source defines the priorities for any timebox. This set ties them to release 1.

SOURCE — "What is MoSCoW Prioritization?", Agile Business Consortium, https://www.agilebusiness.org/?p=1907

acceptance criterion

MEANING — One test that shows a requirement works, in the form Given a situation, when a person acts, then a result that a tester can see.

SOURCE — "Introducing BDD", Dan North, 20 Sep 2006, https://dannorth.net/blog/introducing-bdd/

built-in theme

MEANING — An export theme that comes with the viewer and that the author cannot change or delete. Release 1 has two: Ice Snowstorm and Clay.

SEE ALSO
- export theme

fixed-layout document

MEANING — An export file whose pages look the same on every computer and that the reader cannot easily change. IN-006 names the format.

editable document

MEANING — An export file that the reader can open and change in a word processor. IN-006 names the format.

unreadable document

MEANING — A document in a PRD set whose header the viewer cannot read, so its id, kind, title, or status is not known. A pending section with no content is not unreadable.

contents list

MEANING — The list of every document of the PRD set, in reading order, at the start of an export.

reading order

MEANING — The order of the documents in a PRD set: the root document first, then each section by its order number.

prdf

MEANING — The terminal command that starts the viewer, short for PRD Forge.

item

MEANING — Any entry in a PRD set that has an id, such as FR-008, SC-003, PER-002, or Q-004, and any glossary term. One search result is one item.

item title

MEANING — The first named field of an item: its name, capability, statement, question, or term.

category

MEANING — A filter for search: one category for each kind of section, such as functional requirements or scenarios. A search uses one or more categories, or all of them.

relevance score

MEANING — A number from 0 to 100 on each search result. Matches in the item title score higher than matches in the text, and more matches score higher.

known location

MEANING — A folder where the viewer opened a PRD set before. The viewer remembers it.

backlog

MEANING — The features, epics, stories, and spikes that the authoring tools derive from an approved PRD set. It is a separate set of documents next to the PRD set, and each story names the requirements that it builds.

text size

MEANING — The size of the text in the viewer, which the author can make larger or smaller.

SECTION 15

Change log

DRAFT

VERSION	DATE	AUTHOR	SUMMARY	APPROVALS
0.1.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	First draft of all 15 sections	None yet
0.2.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	prdf, known locations, search scores, fonts; 10 sections to review	None yet
0.3.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	PRD Forge 0.5.1 fields, wireframes WF-001 to WF-009, FR-023 added, FR-006 dropped	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.1	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	WF-009 shows a pending section	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.2	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	HLD review decisions: date, macOS, FR-024, NFR-010	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.3	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	FR-024 reopens the last set	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-27
0.3.4	2026-10-27	Richard Hightower	Neutral folder names in WF-006	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-27
0.4.0	2026-10-27	Richard Hightower	PRD Forge 0.8.1: release line ST-001 to ST-007, WF-010, new front matter fields	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-27
0.5.0	2026-10-27	Richard Hightower	Answers from the open questions: NFR categories, must share, FR-025, SC-008 to SC-012, TR-012, TR-013	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-27
0.5.1	2026-10-28	Richard Hightower	Glossary sources for MoSCoW priority and acceptance criterion	None yet
0.6.0	2026-10-28	Richard Hightower	Sections 1, 2, 8, and 9 above 80; C-001, C-002, and C-004 retired to IN-006, OUT-001, and OUT-003; Q-001 and Q-009 answered	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-28
0.6.1	2026-10-28	Richard Hightower	Release 1 target date moves to 2026-11-06	None yet
0.6.2	2026-10-30	Richard Hightower	Grades in an export are optional and off by default (FR-019)	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-30
0.7.0	2026-10-31	Richard Hightower	FR-008 in more than one category; FR-026 to FR-028 added to release 2	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-31

0.1.0. First draft

The interview wrote all 15 sections. The decisions recorded on 2026-10-26:

- Editing in the viewer is not in release 1 (Q-005, OUT-001).
- Grade findings wait for a later release and a PRD Forge change (Q-004, D-002).

- Search and custom export themes are in release 1.
- Every export shows "Draft" until every document is final (TR-005).
- PDF and Word are the export formats (C-001).
- When the sponsor is not available, the approval waits (Q-006).
- The release 1 target date is 2027-01-31.
- The viewer is free and open source for anyone who uses PRD Forge.

Versions 0.1.0 and 0.2.0 have no approval.

0.3.0. Approved by the sponsor

Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.0 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26. The 14 graded sections moved from review to final. The root, open questions, glossary, and change log stay at draft, so every export still shows "Draft" (TR-005).

0.3.1. A pending section in WF-009

WF-009 now shows how a pending section looks in the contents of an export. The wireframes section returned to review. Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.1 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26, and the wireframes moved to final.

0.3.2. Decisions from the HLD review

The PRD owner decided four items from the HLD review on 2026-10-26:

- REL-001 moves from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-27 (ADV-07).
- Release 1 runs on macOS only. Other operating systems come later (C-004, ADV-03).
- When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the author picks one in the viewer (FR-024, ADV-02).
- The viewer shows only local content. No script runs, and nothing remote loads (NFR-010, ADV-01).

Scope, functional requirements, wireframes, non-functional requirements, constraints, and the release plan returned to review. Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.2 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26. Five of them moved to final. Functional requirements stay at draft: the adversarial grade found one blocking defect (ST-008 has no `must` requirement).

0.3.3. FR-024 reopens the last set

When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the viewer reopens the set that was open in the last session. The list of sets shows only when none of them was open before. This settles which rule wins between FR-002 and FR-024. Functional requirements stay at draft until ST-008 has a `must` requirement.

0.3.4. Neutral folder names in WF-006

The example folders in WF-006 no longer name a client. The wireframes returned to review until the sponsor approves this version.

0.4.0. Updated to PRD Forge 0.8.1

PRD Forge 0.8.1 checks that the release line is one run of J-001 stages, and that REL-001 lists exactly those stages. The PRD owner made these decisions on 2026-10-27:

- The release line is ST-001 to ST-007. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer, and section 6 records the workaround for each.
- Search (IN-004) is part of ST-003, and the export of selected sections (IN-008) is part of ST-005. Release 1 still lets a developer do the work of J-002.
- SC-005 and SC-007 are should, because they are on J-002. FR-008 and FR-012 stay must in release 1, and FR-007 stays should.
- FR-007 and FR-008 move to ST-003, and FR-012 moves to ST-005, to agree with the scope.
- FR-023 says "Select one item of a section and read it without the whole section". It no longer names a control.
- The REL-001 date is committed. The REL-002 date is indicative.
- WF-010 shows the list of PRD sets in docs/prd. It is a state of WF-006, and WF-006 keeps marks 1 to 3.

The other changes copy facts that the PRD text already states into the new front matter fields. FR-012 and FR-013 state a situation in each Given. The root document and section 11 now give the correct release 1 date, 2026-10-27. The wireframes show version 0.4.0. The sponsor approved versions 0.3.3, 0.3.4, and 0.4.0 on 2026-10-27, and the changed sections returned to final.

0.5.0. Answers from the open questions

The PRD owner answered these questions on 2026-10-27:

- Scale, retention, and observability do not apply to the viewer. Section 8 gives the reason for each.
- Nine requirements move from must to should: FR-002, FR-011, FR-016, FR-017, FR-018, FR-019, FR-020, FR-022, and FR-024. They stay in release 1. Release 1 can ship without them.
- SC-008 adds a second unhappy path to J-002: an export with a pending section (Q-008).
- FR-025 shows the findings behind the grade of a section. It is the only requirement of release 2 (REL-002). Its priority is wont, because release 1 does not have it. WF-011 draws it.
- SC-009 is the first use of the viewer, with two PRD sets in docs/prd.
- SC-010 is the J-003 happy path. SC-011 (a rejection with a reason) and SC-012 (the sponsor is not available) come from TR-007 and Q-006.
- LC-001 records how a section moves from pending to final.
- SC-006 is should, because FR-002 is should.
- The PRD owner decides on OUT-001 (editing) at the release 2 review, on 2026-11-06.
- Each non-goal has a reason. The viewer shows one PRD set at a time, because every journey works on one PRD.
- FR-021 and FR-024 keep the folder name docs/prd, because the authoring tools use it and the author sees it. WF-010 keeps its example set names.
- TR-012 and TR-013 give the developer (PER-002) the decisions at ST-008 and ST-010. TR-001 and TR-004 keep only the author's stages.
- Release 1 comes first because it delivers the golden thread J-001. Release 2 comes second because findings are useful only after the author sees all grades in one view (FR-004).

The sponsor approved version 0.5.0 on 2026-10-27, and the changed sections moved to final.

0.5.1. Sources for standard terms

PRD Forge 0.9.0 asks the glossary to cite the published source of each standard term. The glossary entry for MoSCoW priority now cites the Agile Business Consortium. It states that this set ties the priorities to release 1, and that a won't

requirement is not a non-goal. The new entry for acceptance criterion cites Dan North for the Given, when, then form that section 7 uses. The glossary is a draft, so this version needs no approval to keep the other sections final.

0.6.0. Sections 1, 2, 8, and 9 above 80

The PRD owner answered these questions on 2026-10-28:

- In one review of this PRD, the PRD owner searched the files for an item about 10 times, about 3 minutes each (Q-009). P-001 records the cost, about 30 minutes for each review.
- The historic PRDs took about 10 calendar days to the first feedback. This PRD does not count for review time, because it is for a new tool (Q-001). O-001 keeps the 10 days as its baseline.
- Packaging one version by hand takes 2 to 4 hours (P-002).
- The NFR speed targets follow the response time limits of Jakob Nielsen. NFR-008 also covers the known locations and the last set.
- C-001, C-002, and C-004 are retired, because the PRD owner can change them. IN-006 names the export formats, PDF and .docx. OUT-001 records the read-only rule, and the new OUT-003 records macOS only for release 1. The PRD owner revisits OUT-001 and OUT-003 on 2026-11-06. Section 9 keeps only C-003.

Section 2 now sizes S-001 from the 126 people who cloned the authoring tools in the 14 days to 2026-10-28, and names a shared online document and a team script as substitutes. Sections 3, 7, 11, 12, 13, and 14 changed only to match these answers.

The sponsor approved version 0.6.0 on 2026-10-28, and the changed sections moved to final.

0.6.1. Release 1 date

The PRD owner moved the release 1 target date (REL-001) from 2026-10-27 to 2026-11-06 on 2026-10-28. Sections 11 and 13 changed and returned to review.

First draft of all 15 sections from the PRD Forge interview. Decisions on 2026-10-26: edit

VERSION	0.1.0
DATE	2026-10-26
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5 • 6 • 7 • 8 • 9 • 10 • 11 • 12 • 13 • 14 • 15
RESOLVES	• Q-004 • Q-005 • Q-006

Engineering review fixes and new decisions. Added FR-021 (the prdf command) and FR-022 (re

VERSION	0.2.0
DATE	2026-10-26
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 2 • 4 • 5 • 6 • 7 • 8 • 9 • 11 • 12 • 13 • 14
RESOLVES	• Q-003 • Q-007

Updated to PRD Forge 0.5.1. Added persona short names, stage acceptance, scenario prioriti

VERSION 0.3.0

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 4
- 5
- 7
- 12

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-26

DECISION approved

WF-009 shows a pending section in the contents, and sections 1 and 4 as final. The wirefra

VERSION 0.3.1

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 7

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-26

DECISION approved

Decisions from the HLD review. Release 1 moves to 2026-10-27. Release 1 runs on macOS only

VERSION 0.3.2

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 13

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-26

DECISION approved

FR-024 reopens the set that was open in the last session. The list of sets shows only when

VERSION 0.3.3

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 7

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-27

DECISION approved

WF-006 uses neutral example folder names. The wireframes return to review until the sponso

VERSION 0.3.4

DATE 2026-10-27

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 7

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-27

DECISION approved

Updated to PRD Forge 0.8.1. The release line is ST-001 to ST-007 of J-001. ST-006 and ST-0

VERSION 0.4.0

DATE 2026-10-27

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 10
- 11
- 12
- 13
- 15

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-27

DECISION approved

Answers from the open questions. Section 8 records scale, retention, and observability as

VERSION 0.5.0

DATE 2026-10-27

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 10
- 12
- 13
- 15

RESOLVES
- Q-008

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-27

DECISION approved

PRD Forge 0.9.0 asks the glossary to cite the source of each standard term. MoSCoW priorit

VERSION 0.5.1

DATE 2026-10-28

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 14

Raises sections 1, 2, 8, and 9 above a grade of 80 under PRD Forge 0.9.0. Section 1 gives

VERSION 0.6.0

DATE 2026-10-28

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 11
- 12
- 13
- 14
- 15

RESOLVES
- Q-001
- Q-009

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE	Sponsor (PER-004)
DATE	2026-10-28
DECISION	approved

The PRD owner moved the release 1 target date (REL-001) from 2026-10-27 to 2026-11-06.

VERSION	0.6.1
DATE	2026-10-28
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 11 • 13

An export leaves out the grades by default. FR-019 keeps the status of every section in th

VERSION	0.6.2
DATE	2026-10-30
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 7

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE	Sponsor (PER-004)
DATE	2026-10-30
DECISION	approved

The PRD catches up with the viewer. FR-008 searches one or more categories. FR-026 adds th

VERSION	0.7.0
DATE	2026-10-31
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 7 • 13 • 14

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE	Sponsor (PER-004)
DATE	2026-10-31
DECISION	approved

The owner answers Q-002. Two of the stakeholders who review a typical PRD have the authori

VERSION	0.7.1
DATE	2026-11-01
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 1 • 6 • 7 • 12 • 13
RESOLVES	• Q-002

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE	Sponsor (PER-004)
DATE	2026-11-01
DECISION	approved